Nosh CV Intern Task — Report

Repo: github.com/maulik0jain/NoshInternTask · last updated 31 Oct 2026

Part	Status
Task 1 — ground-truth masks with a pretrained model	done
Task 2a — dev / eval split (4:1, leakage-aware)	done, frozen
Task 2b — classical image-processing segmentation + experiment log	done — 32 trials, 12 sweeps (§3)
Task 3 — evaluation & analysis	done — eval IoU 0.618 (§4)
Round 2 — the five improvements from §4, tried on dev	done — dev IoU 0.589 → 0.669, eval 0.618 → 0.613 (§5)
Round 3 — stopping the overfitting (scene rule, leave-one-scene-out)	done — held-out-scene estimate 0.615, eval 0.612 (§6)
Task 4 — video tracking (videos: Google Drive)	done — vs SAM 2.1: MOTA 0.159, IDF1 0.216, matched-egg IoU 0.910 (§7)

Summary

- Ground truth: Grounding DINO (text "egg.") → boxes → SAM 2.1 masks, every overlay checked by eye
- Split: whole scenes go to one side (85 dev / 25 eval), checked for near-duplicates across the split
- Classical method: colour gate → **multi-threshold search for egg-shaped blobs** → GrabCut edge refinement → watershed split. No learning, all parameters picked on dev
- Eval (run once): IoU **0.618** (median 0.817), Dice 0.683, boundary F1 0.489; dev IoU 0.589
- Main gap: eggs on white / pale backgrounds and partly hidden eggs — the method relies on "the egg is the brightest egg-shaped thing"
- **Round 2** (§5): the improvements from the Task 3 analysis, tried one by one on dev → dev IoU 0.589 → 0.669; eval 0.618 → 0.613 → the dev gain did not carry over to the unseen eval scenes. Round 1 stays the clean eval number
- **Round 3** (§6): decide per scene and check the selection by leave-one-scene-out → the held-out-scene estimate (0.615) matched eval (0.612); round 2's dev number had overshot by 0.056. Same eval as before, with 3 changes instead of 5 and an honest estimate
- **Task 4** (§7): SAM 2.1 video tracking is the reference. T21 + my tracker: MOTA 0.159, IDF1 0.216. The errors are in the segmentation (touching eggs merged with their reflections on a glossy table, an egg under the hand), not in the tracking
- **Video as a fresh test**: round 1 beats rounds 2/3 here (IoU 0.868 vs 0.681). The skin filter rounds 2/3 turned off is what keeps the reflections out → one more sign the dev decisions don't carry to new scenes

At a glance — what I changed and what it did

The three pipelines, on every test

Pipeline	Changes vs round 1	Dev, scenes it was tuned on	Dev, held-out scene (LOSO)	Eval (25 images)	Video IoU (fresh test)	Video + tracker: MOTA / IDF1
Round 1 (T11)	– (built in Task 2)	0.589	–	0.618	0.868	0.826 / 0.605 *
Round 2 (T18)	skin filter off, ellipse prior, blob splitting, edge ranking, shape / texture reject	0.669	0.639	0.613	0.677	–
Round 3 (T21)	ellipse prior, shape / texture reject, skin filter off	0.655	0.615	0.612	0.681	0.159 / 0.216

- * Round 1 + tracker was run after the video's fresh test showed round 1 is best there → not a clean number. The planned Task 4 run is round 3 (T21)
- Eval was looked at once per round (3 times, each disclosed). The clean, one-shot number is round 1: 0.618

What the numbers say

- **Round 1 → 2**: dev 0.589 → 0.669, eval 0.618 → 0.613 → the fixes worked on the dev scenes they were made for, not on new ones (overfitting to dev)
- **Round 2 → 3**: decisions judged per scene, and the selection checked on held-out scenes. Eval stays at 0.612, but now the estimate made before eval (0.615) matches it. 3 changes instead of 5
- **Video** (a scene none of the rounds saw): round 1 0.868 vs round 3 0.681. Turning the skin filter off: -0.130 IoU there, because on this video the filter also removes the brown table and the egg reflections
- **Tracking**: same tracker on both. MOTA 0.159 with round 3, 0.826 with round 1 → the tracker works; the segmentation decides the score
- By far the biggest single step: GrabCut edge refinement in round 1 (T8, table below)

Every trial, in order

- Dev split only. Δ = change in dev IoU vs the trial it builds on. Dropped trials stay in the list (details per trial: §3, §5, §6; full log: `experiments/LOG.md`)

Trial	Change	Dev IoU	Δ vs parent	Kept?
Round 1 — building the pipeline (Task 2)				
T0	Otsu threshold on grayscale (baseline)	0.366	–	no
T1	Otsu on CIE Lab L* instead of grayscale	0.340	-0.025	no
T2	+ gray-world white balance and CLAHE on L*	0.266	-0.074	no
T3	+ remove skin pixels (YCbCr box, Chai & Ngan 1999)	0.377	+0.011	yes
T4	+ keep only low-saturation pixels (HSV S <= 60)	0.392	+0.015	yes
T5	k-means (k=3) in Lab instead of Otsu; keep the brightest, least-coloured cluster	0.408	+0.032	yes
T5b	k-means candidate + low-saturation filter (S <= 40, from the T4 sweep)	0.415	+0.006	yes
T6	+ morphology (open r=3, close r=7, fill holes)	0.416	+0.001	yes
T7	+ connected-component filters (area, solidity, axis ratio, border contact)	0.312	-0.103	no
T7b	Multi-threshold egg search (24 thresholds, blobs scored by ellipse fit x solidity) replaces the single Otsu/k-means threshold	0.448	+0.032	yes
T7c	Search on Lab L* instead of grayscale (from the T7b channel sweep)	0.464	+0.016	yes
T8	+ GrabCut refinement seeded from the mask (eroded = sure egg, >70 px outside = sure background)	0.566	+0.102	yes
T9	+ ellipse regularisation (blobs with ellipse IoU >= 0.9 are replaced by their fitted ellipse)	0.561	-0.005	no
T10	+ distance-transform watershed to split touching eggs into separate instances	0.566	+0.000	yes
T11	Fallback pass with a looser shape score (0.65) for images where the search found nothing	0.589	+0.023	yes
T11b	Fallback pass returns at most 1 egg	0.579	-0.010	no
Round 2 — fixes from the Task 3 analysis				
T12	skin filter off	0.609	+0.020	yes
T12b	skin filter only removes large skin regions that touch the image border	0.592	+0.003	no
T13	GrabCut also gets each egg's fitted ellipse (x1.15) as 'probably egg'	0.646	+0.037	yes
T13b	Local Otsu growth around each found egg before GrabCut	0.633	+0.024	no
T13c	T13 + local Otsu growth (both shaded-side fixes together)	0.645	-0.001	no
T14	Split non-egg-shaped blobs with watershed inside the search and score each piece	0.650	+0.004	yes
T15	Egg score also rewards blob outlines that lie on Canny edges (weight 0.5)	0.339	-0.307	no
T15b	Add ellipses fitted to Canny edge chains as extra egg candidates	0.573	-0.073	no
T15c	Edge support only ranks candidates; the 0.80 cut stays on the plain shape score	0.652	+0.006	yes
T16	Reject rectangular blobs (area / min bounding rect > 0.9) and textured blobs (mean |Laplacian| > 5)	0.655	+0.009	yes
T17	All kept round-2 changes together: T13 + T14 + T15c + T16	0.660	+0.005	yes
T18	T17 with edge weight 0.3 (from sweep T17_edge_weight)	0.669	+0.009	yes
Round 3 — per-scene decisions + leave-one-scene-out				
T19	Round 3, step 1: ellipse prior on the round-1 pipeline	0.635	+0.046	yes
T19b	Round 3, step 1 alternative: ellipse prior + clip (GrabCut may not grow past the fitted ellipse x 1.3)	0.569	-0.020	no
T20	Round 3, step 2: shape / texture reject on T19	0.643	+0.008	yes
T21	Round 3, step 3: skin filter off on T20 - final round-3 pipeline	0.655	+0.013	yes

0. Dataset — quick facts

- 110 images, all 640×640 (Roboflow resized with "stretch")
- Roboflow **folder** export → class labels only. **No boxes, no masks.**
- README says no augmentation → checked: 110 unique source ids, 0 copies
- 1–3 eggs per image, almost all white eggs

- Hard backgrounds: white bag, white egg trays, water in a steel pot, leaves, ash, hands, glossy lids

1. Task 1 — ground truth with pretrained models

Model choice

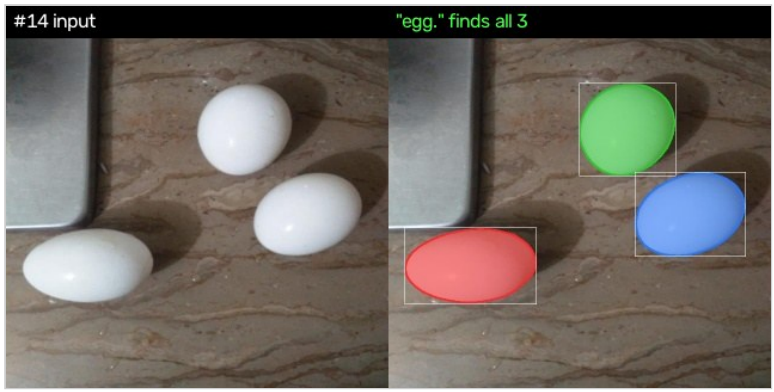
- SAM 2.1 needs a prompt (point / box) — it doesn't find eggs on its own
- Dataset has no boxes → **Grounding DINO** (open-vocabulary detector) turns the text `"egg."` into boxes
- Each box → **SAM 2.1 Hiera Base+** → mask
- Why not the lightest model: GT is made once, offline. Every GT mistake later counts as a mistake of my classical method → spend compute here
- Why not SAM "segment everything": it also segments hands, floor, shadows → messy filtering
- Also considered SAM 3 (text prompt built in) — heavier (~850M params) and gated weights; Grounding DINO + SAM 2.1 was enough

Pipeline

1. Grounding DINO base, prompt `"egg."`, box thr 0.30, text thr 0.25
2. Box cleanup: NMS (IoU 0.5), drop boxes >95% of the image, drop a "group" box that contains ≥2 other boxes
3. SAM 2.1, one mask per box (a box prompt isn't ambiguous → single-mask output)
4. Mask cleanup: clip to box (+6 px), fill holes (specular highlights), drop specks <15% of the biggest piece
5. Drop duplicate masks (>50% covered by a more confident egg)
6. Manual review overrides — 2 images, see below
7. Save binary mask, instance mask (ids left → right), overlay, `annotations.json`

Problems found while checking every overlay

Problem	Cause	Fix
Output files had wrong names	Filenames have extra dots (`x_jpg.rf.<hash>.jpg`), `with_suffix` cut off the hash	Build names from the stem
2 images missing one egg (#14, #35)	Prompt `"an egg."` gave those eggs 0.28–0.29 (threshold 0.30)	Prompt `"egg."`: real eggs 0.55–0.62, junk ≤ 0.10
Egg cut by a fridge-tray bar lost a piece (#24)	Cleanup kept only the largest piece	Keep all pieces ≥ 15% of the largest
Egg's reflection in a glossy lid detected as an egg (#61, #74)	Looks like a faint egg (det 0.36 / 0.47). Any rule for it would be fitted to 2 images	Manual override file `ground_truth_overrides.json`, with reasons
Not fixed: #17 — egg piece on the far side of a stem missing	SAM never segments that piece	Known GT error → shows up in Task 3



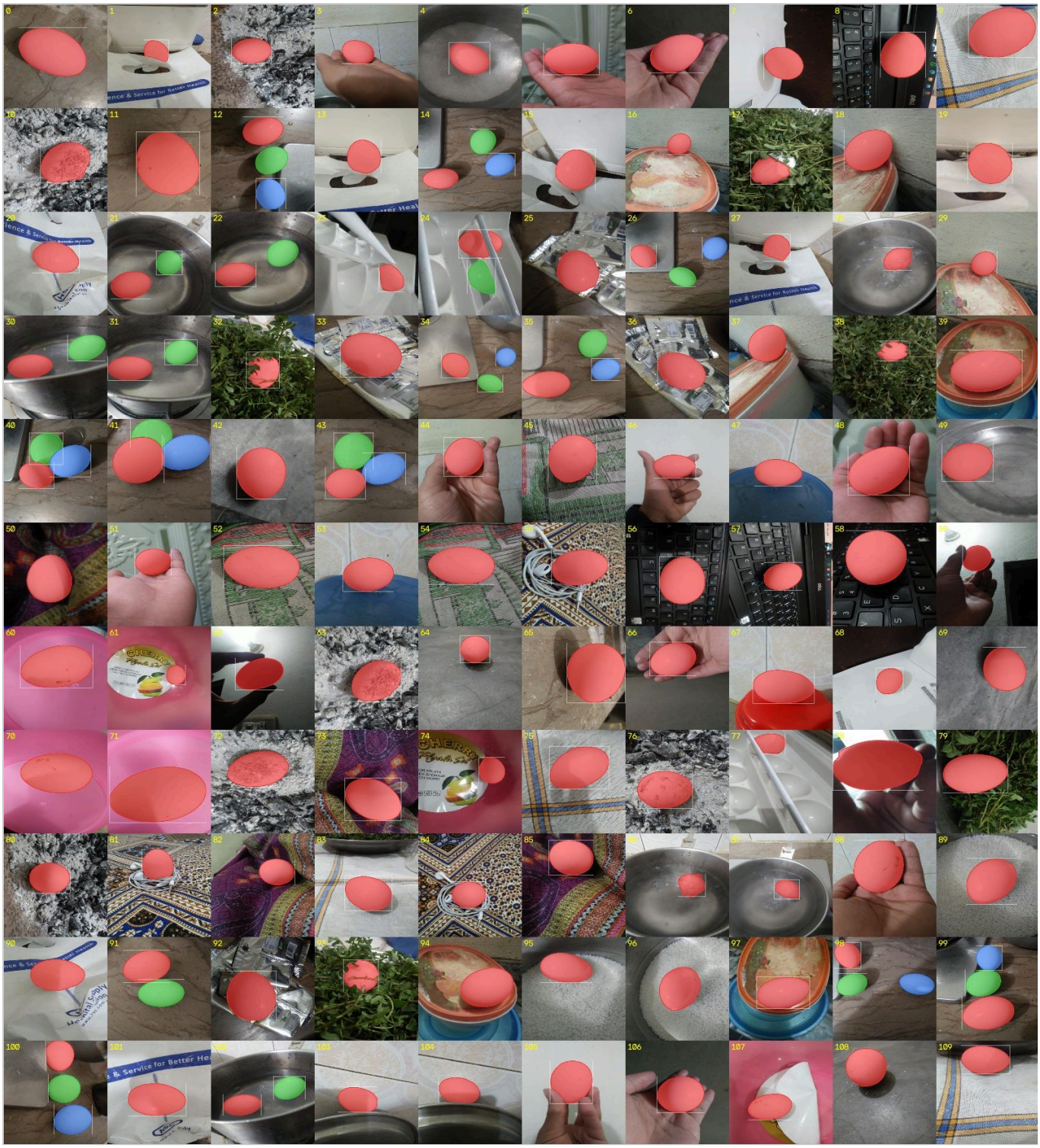
Prompt fix: all three eggs found with `"egg."`



Row 1: piece behind the bar kept. Row 2: reflection removed by override. Row 3: known GT limitation (not fixed).

Result

- **110 images, 139 eggs** — 92 images with 1 egg, 7 with 2, 11 with 3
- All 110 overlays checked by eye (full review sheet on the next page)
- GT = **visible** egg pixels. Leaves / fingers on top of an egg are not egg
- Known GT weak spots: eggs under leaves (#17), eggs partly hidden by tray bars



All 110 ground-truth overlays (colour = egg instance, white = detector box)

2. Task 2a — dev / eval split (4:1)

Why a random split is wrong here

- Photos were shot in sessions: same pot, same keyboard, same bag, same hand — different angles
- Random split → same scene in dev and eval → tune thresholds on a scene, then "test" on the same scene → eval looks better than it is
- Same idea as splitting by subject, not by frame

Steps

1. **Augmented copies**: strip `.rf.<hash>` → source id. 110 ids, 0 duplicates
2. **Near-identical shots**: pHash (64-bit DCT), Hamming ≤ 10 → 1 pair, same group
3. **Same scene**: DINOv2-small embeddings (CLS + mean patch), average-linkage clustering, cosine distance 0.30 → 35 groups
   - 0.30 picked by looking at the groups. 0.40 merged marble floor with grey floor (19 images) and still split the pot
4. **Manual merges (8)**: same physical setup the embedding kept apart — pot, keyboard, fridge tray, white bag + holder, pink bowl, painted lid, grey floor, towel + rug → `scene_merges.json` → **19 groups**
5. **Split whole groups**. Rules: eval = 17–23% of images; multi-egg share within ±5 points of overall; then as many scenes as possible. Seeded search (seed 42)
   - Try 1: `StratifiedGroupKFold` → valid, but eval had only 4 scenes
   - Try 2: soft penalty → 7 scenes, but only 1 multi-egg image in eval (too easy) → made the multi-egg share a hard rule

Result

	dev	eval
Images	85	25
Eggs	109	30
Scenes (groups)	14	5
Images with 2+ eggs	15%	20%

- Eval scenes: steel pot (12, incl. 5 multi-egg), painted container (7), dark-room hand (3), blue bowl (2), red bowl (1)
- 85 : 25 = 77 / 23, not exactly 80 / 20 — whole groups don't divide evenly

Leakage check

For each eval image: cosine similarity (DINOv2) to its most similar dev image.

Split	Mean of max similarity	Eval images with a near-twin in dev (> 0.9)
Random split, same size	0.80	16%
Group split (used)	**0.59**	**0%**

- pHash near-duplicate pairs across dev / eval: 0

Rules from here on

- Split frozen in `data/splits/split.csv` (committed)

- All Task 2 tuning and experiments on **dev only** — `run_experiment.py` and `sweep.py` can't even load eval
- Eval touched **once**, by `final_eval.py`, which refuses to run a second time into the same folder. (A second, separate look came later in round 2, §5)

Limitations

- Scene grouping is partly manual (my judgement) — every merge is listed in a file
- Some scene types are only in dev (leaves, ash, bright-room hands, marble-floor multi-egg) → eval numbers say less about those

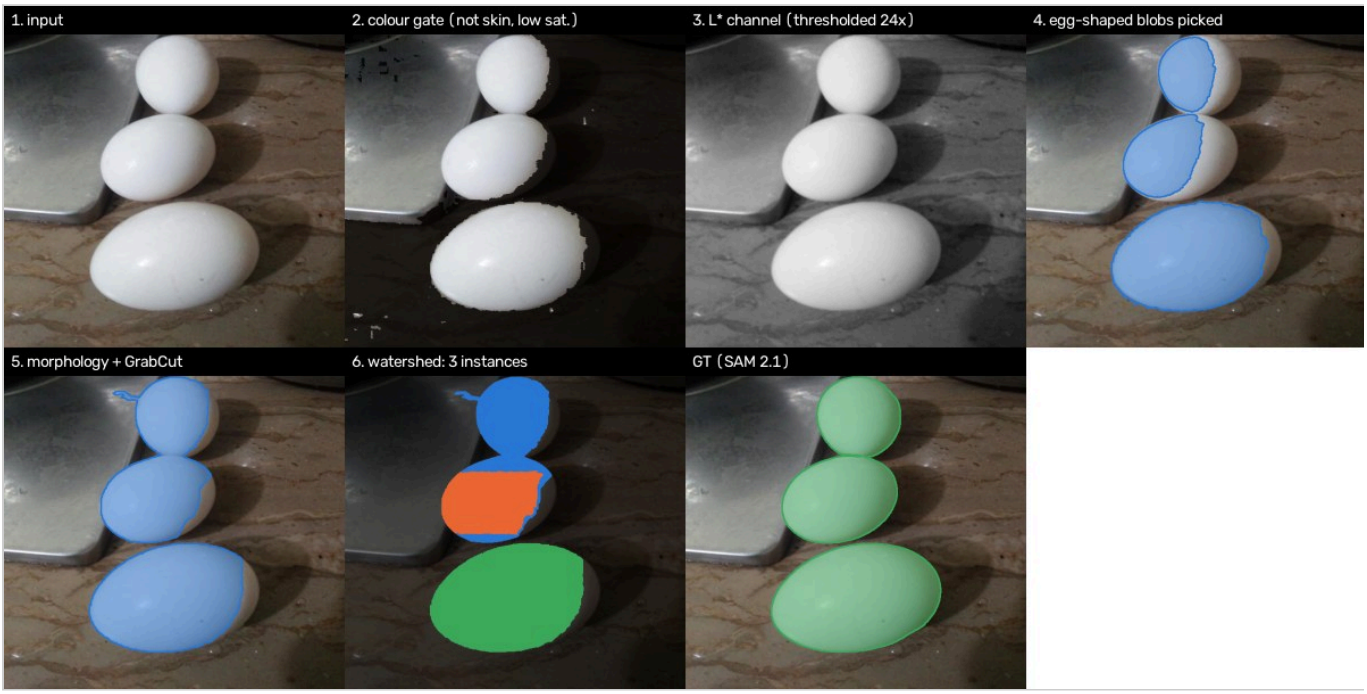


All 19 groups. Orange = eval, green = dev.

3. Task 2b — classical segmentation

Idea in one line

- An egg here = a **bright, almost colourless, egg-shaped** blob. No single threshold separates it from every background → try many thresholds, keep the blobs that look most like an ellipse, then fix their edges with GrabCut and split touching eggs with watershed



Final pipeline (T11) stage by stage on dev image #136 (three touching eggs). Step 4 keeps only the lit part of each egg; GrabCut (5) grows it to the shaded edge; watershed (6) separates the two eggs GrabCut merged.

Final algorithm (T11) — stages and parameters

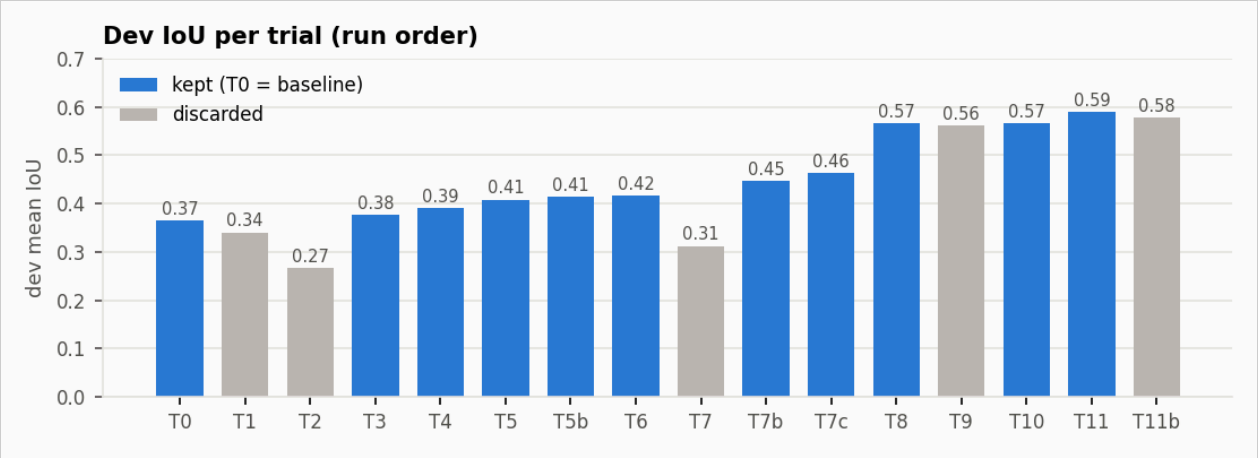
1. **Blur**: Gaussian 5×5 — shell texture and JPEG noise make ragged blob outlines
2. **Colour gate** — remove pixels that can't be egg before any thresholding
   - Skin: YCbCr box Cb 77–127, Cr 133–173 (Chai & Ngan 1999) → hands / fingers out. *Turned out to also remove warm-lit egg pixels — see the §4 ablation*
   - Saturation: HSV S ≤ 40 → coloured bowls, leaves, pink lids out (eggs are white / grey)
3. **Multi-threshold egg search** on the Lab L* channel (my own stage, similar idea to MSER)
   - 24 thresholds, evenly spaced between the 20th and 99.5th percentile of L* in that image
   - At each: `L* ≥ t` AND colour gate → opening 3 px (cuts thin bridges to background) → connected components → fill holes
   - Shape check per blob: area 0.003–0.6 of the image, solidity ≥ 0.85, axis ratio ≤ 2.2, ≤ 0.35 of the outline on the image border
   - **Egg score** = IoU(blob, its fitted ellipse) × solidity — an egg seen from above is ~1.0; background blobs are not. Keep score ≥ 0.8
   - Pick greedily, best score first. The same egg shows up at several thresholds (nested blobs) → take the **largest** one within 0.03 of the best score, so the egg isn't shrunk to its bright centre. Skip blobs that overlap a picked egg by > 0.2
   - Fallback: if nothing reaches 0.8, search once more with score ≥ 0.65 (only images that would otherwise be empty)
4. **Morphology**: opening 3 px, closing 7 px, fill holes (specular highlights inside eggs)

5. **GrabCut** (Rother 2004) on the original colours, seeded from the mask
   - Mask eroded by 10 px = sure egg · mask = probably egg · up to 70 px around it = probably background · further away = sure background
   - 5 iterations, fixed RNG seed; new blobs that don't touch the seed are dropped
   - Why: the search finds the lit part of the egg. The shaded side is often darker than parts of the background, so no threshold gets it — a colour model (GMM + graph cut) can
6. **Watershed** (Vincent & Soille 1991) on the distance transform of each blob: cores = pixels ≥ 0.6 × max distance (≥ 30 px) → one instance per core. Splits touching eggs (needed for Task 4)

- Output: binary mask + instance mask per image. 1.38 s / image on CPU (most of it GrabCut)
- Code: `src/eggseg/classical.py` (one small function per stage), parameters: `configs/default.yaml` + `experiments/T11/config.yaml`

How I ran experiments

- Each trial = a folder `experiments/Tn/` with `config.yaml`: which trial it builds on, what changed, why, decision + reason (written after the run)
- `run_experiment.py` runs it on the **85 dev images** → `results.json`, per-image CSV, worst-case panels. Small parameter sweeps with `sweep.py`, also dev only
- **Decision rule** (fixed before starting): keep a change if dev mean IoU goes up; if IoU ties, keep only if boundary F1 or instance F1 improves
- Metrics (same code as Task 3): IoU, Dice, pixel precision / recall, boundary F1 (2 px), instance F1 (match at IoU ≥ 0.5), number of empty predictions
- Table and per-trial notes below are generated from those files (`build_log.py` → `experiments/LOG.md`), not typed



Dev mean IoU of every trial in the order I ran them. Grey = discarded.

Experiment log — all trials (dev, 85 images)

Trial	Change	IoU mean	IoU med.	Prec.	Recall	Bnd F1	Inst F1	Empty	Decision
T0	Otsu threshold on grayscale (baseline)	0.366	0.273	0.407	0.879	0.158	0.008	0	baseline
T1	Otsu on CIE Lab L* instead of grayscale	0.340	0.256	0.373	0.896	0.143	0.007	0	discarded
T2	+ gray-world white balance and CLAHE on L*	0.266	0.206	0.282	0.875	0.077	0.005	0	discarded
T3	+ remove skin pixels (YCbCr box, Chai & Ngan 1999)	0.377	0.290	0.451	0.815	0.159	0.007	0	kept
T4	+ keep only low-saturation pixels (HSV S <= 60)	0.392	0.292	0.470	0.815	0.172	0.008	0	kept
T5	k-means (k=3) in Lab instead of Otsu; keep the brightest, least-coloured cluster	0.408	0.333	0.523	0.741	0.189	0.013	0	kept
T5b	k-means candidate + low-saturation filter (S <= 40, from the T4 sweep)	0.415	0.333	0.531	0.740	0.194	0.015	0	kept
T6	+ morphology (open r=3, close r=7, fill holes)	0.416	0.340	0.532	0.759	0.216	0.091	0	kept
T7	+ connected-component filters (area, solidity, axis ratio, border contact)	0.312	0.000	0.744	0.349	0.184	0.482	36	discarded
T7b	Multi-threshold egg search (24 thresholds, blobs scored by ellipse fit x solidity) replaces the single Otsu/k-means threshold	0.448	0.466	0.879	0.464	0.249	0.473	12	kept
T7c	Search on Lab L* instead of grayscale (from the T7b channel sweep)	0.464	0.483	0.902	0.483	0.257	0.493	11	kept
T8	+ GrabCut refinement seeded from the mask (eroded = sure egg, >70 px outside = sure background)	0.566	0.654	0.894	0.605	0.445	0.608	11	kept
T9	+ ellipse regularisation (blobs with ellipse IoU >= 0.9 are replaced by their fitted ellipse)	0.561	0.644	0.887	0.603	0.331	0.608	11	discarded
T10	+ distance-transform watershed to split touching eggs into separate instances	0.566	0.654	0.894	0.605	0.445	0.618	11	kept
T11	Fallback pass with a looser shape score (0.65) for images where the search found nothing	0.589	0.660	0.833	0.639	0.458	0.569	2	kept
T11b	Fallback pass returns at most 1 egg	0.579	0.660	0.821	0.618	0.456	0.603	2	discarded

How the experiments led to the algorithm

- **T0–T1: one global threshold.** Otsu on grey (0.366) finds eggs (recall 0.88) but also every bright background (precision 0.41). L* alone was worse
- **T2: global colour fixes hurt** (0.266) — gray-world and CLAHE brighten the background as much as the egg
- **T3–T5b: remove what can't be egg** — skin, then saturated colour, then k-means in Lab instead of Otsu. Small, steady gains (0.377 → 0.415), precision still poor
- **T6–T7: clean-up and shape filters.** Morphology was a tie. Shape filters on the single-threshold mask **broke** it (0.312, 36 empty masks): the egg is often glued to bright background, so filtering throws the egg away with it → the threshold itself is the problem
- **T7b–T7c: search over thresholds with an egg-shape score** — the key change. Precision jumps (0.53 → 0.88), IoU 0.464. Now the failure flips to under-segmentation (recall 0.48)
- **T8: GrabCut** fixes exactly that — biggest single gain (0.464 → 0.566, boundary F1 0.26 → 0.45)
- **T9: ellipse fitting** made edges worse (real eggs aren't perfect ellipses, partly hidden eggs even less) → discarded
- **T10: watershed** — no IoU change (as expected), instance F1 0.608 → 0.618

- **T11: fallback pass** for images with no egg found: empty masks 11 → 2, IoU 0.566 → 0.589 — but more false eggs (instance F1 0.569); T11b tried to limit that and lost IoU

Parameter sweeps (dev)

Sweep (dev)	On top of	Values → dev IoU mean	Picked
`watershed.peak_rel`	T10	0.4 → 0.566 · 0.5 → 0.566 · 0.6 → 0.566 · 0.7 → 0.566	0.6
`candidate.fallback_min_score`	T11	0.55 → 0.588 · 0.6 → 0.588 · 0.65 → 0.589 · 0.72 → 0.579	0.65
`saturation.s_max`	T4	25 → 0.395 · 40 → 0.395 · 60 → 0.392 · 90 → 0.383	25
`morphology.open`	T7	3 → 0.312 · 7 → 0.325 · 11 → 0.368 · 15 → 0.362	11
`candidate.channel`	T7b	"gray" → 0.448 · "L" → 0.464 · "whiteness" → 0.455	"L"
`candidate.min_score`	T7b	0.6 → 0.419 · 0.7 → 0.443 · 0.75 → 0.448 · 0.8 → 0.448	0.8
`saturation.s_max`	T7b	40 → 0.448 · 60 → 0.447 · 90 → 0.443 · 255 → 0.442	40
`grabcut.bg_dilate`	T8	15 → 0.515 · 25 → 0.536 · 45 → 0.559 · 70 → 0.566 · 100 → 0.563	70
`ellipse.min_fit_iou`	T9	0.9 → 0.561 · 0.95 → 0.565 · 0.97 → 0.565	0.95

Per-trial notes (what / why / params / result / decision)

T0 Otsu threshold on grayscale (baseline) `baseline`

- **Why:** Eggs are usually the brightest thing in the photo; Otsu picks the bright/dark split with no tuning.
- **Params:** on top of default → none (baseline)
- **Dev:** IoU 0.366 (median 0.273), boundary F1 0.158, instance F1 0.008, empty masks 0
- **Decision:** Reference point. High recall but low precision: Otsu takes every bright region, not just the egg.

T1 Otsu on CIE Lab L* instead of grayscale `discarded`

- **Why:** L* is perceptual lightness and ignores colour, so e.g. a saturated pink bowl is not "brighter" than it looks.
- **Params:** on top of T0 → `candidate: {"channel": "L"}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.340 (median 0.256), boundary F1 0.143, instance F1 0.007, empty masks 0
- **Decision:** IoU fell (vs T0). With one global threshold, L* lets in even more bright background. Re-tested later inside the multi-threshold search (T7c), where it won.

T2 + gray-world white balance and CLAHE on L* `discarded`

- **Why:** Warm bulbs tint white eggs cream; CLAHE lifts eggs in dim/backlit photos.
- **Params:** on top of T1 → `preprocess: {"white_balance": true, "clahe": {"enabled": true, "clip": 2.0, "tile": 8}}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.266 (median 0.206), boundary F1 0.077, instance F1 0.005, empty masks 0
- **Decision:** IoU fell sharply. Gray-world shifts colours in scenes dominated by one colour (pink bowl, green leaves), and CLAHE brightens the background as much as the egg, so Otsu took more background.

T3 + remove skin pixels (YCbCr box, Chai & Ngan 1999) `kept`

- **Why:** 14 images have a hand; a lit palm is as bright as the egg and gets swallowed by Otsu.
- **Params:** on top of T0 → `skin: {"enabled": true}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.377 (median 0.290), boundary F1 0.159, instance F1 0.007, empty masks 0
- **Decision:** IoU and precision up vs T0; palms stop being swallowed with the egg.

T4 + keep only low-saturation pixels (HSV S <= 60) `kept`

- **Why:** Eggs are white/cream (near-colourless); many bright backgrounds are coloured (pink bowl, green leaves, wood, rugs).
- **Params:** on top of T3 → `saturation: {"enabled": true, "s_max": 60}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.392 (median 0.292), boundary F1 0.172, instance F1 0.008, empty masks 0
- **Decision:** IoU up vs T3. Sweep T4_s_max: 25 and 40 tie, 40 used from T5b on because it is gentler on cream eggs.

T5 k-means (k=3) in Lab instead of Otsu; keep the brightest, least-coloured cluster `kept`

- **Why:** Otsu splits the histogram in two; with 3 clusters, egg / bright background / dark background can separate.
- **Params:** on top of T3 → `candidate: {"method": "kmeans", "k": 3, "chroma_weight": 1.0}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.408 (median 0.333), boundary F1 0.189, instance F1 0.013, empty masks 0
- **Decision:** Better than Otsu (T4) as the candidate generator: IoU and precision up.

T5b k-means candidate + low-saturation filter (S <= 40, from the T4 sweep) `kept`

- **Why:** T4 and T5 helped separately; check whether they stack.
- **Params:** on top of T5 → `saturation: {"enabled": true, "s_max": 40}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.415 (median 0.333), boundary F1 0.194, instance F1 0.015, empty masks 0
- **Decision:** T4 and T5 stack: IoU up again.

T6 + morphology (open r=3, close r=7, fill holes) kept

- **Why:** Raw masks are speckled (ash, rug texture) and have holes at specular highlights and dirt marks.
- **Params:** on top of T5b → `morphology: {"enabled": true, "open": 3, "close": 7, "fill_holes": true}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.416 (median 0.340), boundary F1 0.216, instance F1 0.091, empty masks 0
- **Decision:** IoU about the same, boundary F1 and instance F1 clearly up (fewer specks, filled highlights).

T7 + connected-component filters (area, solidity, axis ratio, border contact) discarded

- **Why:** Precision is the problem (~0.5); most false positives are big, irregular or border-hugging bright background regions.
- **Params:** on top of T6 → `components: {"enabled": true}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.312 (median 0.000), boundary F1 0.184, instance F1 0.482, empty masks 36
- **Decision:** IoU fell and 36 dev images got an empty mask: one global threshold glues the egg to bright background (ash, cables, white bag, towel), so the shape filter throws the egg away together with the background. Sweep T7_open: stronger opening helps but stays below T6.

T7b Multi-threshold egg search (24 thresholds, blobs scored by ellipse fit x solidity) replaces the single Otsu/k-means threshold kept

- **Why:** T7 failed because one global threshold glues the egg to bright background, so the shape filter throws both away (36 empty images). Trying many thresholds gives the egg a chance to separate at some level.
- **Params:** on top of T6 → `candidate: {"method": "search", "channel": "gray"}`, `components: {"enabled": false}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.448 (median 0.466), boundary F1 0.249, instance F1 0.473, empty masks 12
- **Decision:** Best so far and precision up a lot; fixes the T7 failure mode. Sweeps: min_score 0.75 and 0.8 tie on mean IoU, 0.8 kept for its better median and instance F1; s_max 40 still best.

T7c Search on Lab L* instead of grayscale (from the T7b channel sweep) kept

- **Why:** T1 rejected L* with a single Otsu threshold; with shape-scored multi-threshold search the comparison can come out differently, so it was re-tested.
- **Params:** on top of T7b → `candidate: {"channel": "L"}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.464 (median 0.483), boundary F1 0.257, instance F1 0.493, empty masks 11
- **Decision:** IoU up vs T7b: the channel sweep reverses the T1 result once candidates are chosen by shape.

T8 + GrabCut refinement seeded from the mask (eroded = sure egg, >70 px outside = sure background) kept

- **Why:** The search under-segments (precision ~0.88, recall ~0.48) - it often keeps only the bright cap of the egg. GrabCut's colour models can grow the mask out to the real egg edge.
- **Params:** on top of T7c → `grabcut: {"enabled": true, "iters": 5, "erode": 10, "bg_dilate": 70}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.566 (median 0.654), boundary F1 0.445, instance F1 0.608, empty masks 11
- **Decision:** Largest single gain: GrabCut grows the egg cap out to its real edge (recall and boundary F1 up). bg_dilate 70 chosen by sweep T8_bg_dilate. Two code fixes found here: fixed RNG seed (runs were not repeatable) and drop GrabCut blobs that don't touch the seed (they were new background objects).

T9 + ellipse regularisation (blobs with ellipse IoU >= 0.9 are replaced by their fitted ellipse) discarded

- **Why:** Eggs are near-elliptical from most viewpoints; snapping clean blobs to the ellipse should fix dents from highlights/shadows on the outline. Irregular blobs (eggs behind fingers/leaves) are left alone because the GT only covers the visible part.
- **Params:** on top of T8 → `ellipse: {"enabled": true, "min_fit_iou": 0.9, "mode": "replace"}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.561 (median 0.644), boundary F1 0.331, instance F1 0.608, empty masks 11
- **Decision:** IoU slightly down and boundary F1 down a lot: real egg outlines are egg-shaped (one blunt end), not ellipses, so snapping moves correct edges. Stricter fit (sweep T9_min_fit_iou) still loses.

T10 + distance-transform watershed to split touching eggs into separate instances kept

- **Why:** 5 images have touching eggs; a merged blob counts as zero correct instances. Binary IoU barely changes; instance F1 should.
- **Params:** on top of T8 → `watershed: {"enabled": true, "peak_rel": 0.6, "min_core_px": 30}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.566 (median 0.654), boundary F1 0.445, instance F1 0.618, empty masks 11
- **Decision:** Binary IoU unchanged (as expected), instance F1 up: touching eggs now come out as separate objects. Needed for Task 4 tracking.

T11 Fallback pass with a looser shape score (0.65) for images where the search found nothing kept

- **Why:** 11 dev images still get an empty mask (IoU 0). The min_score sweep showed 0.6 leaves only 2 empty but hurts the other images, so the looser score is applied only where the strict pass found nothing.
- **Params:** on top of T10 → `candidate: {"fallback_min_score": 0.65}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.589 (median 0.660), boundary F1 0.458, instance F1 0.569, empty masks 2
- **Decision:** IoU up and empty masks 11 -> 2 (the two left, #30 and #155, are white eggs in front of a white bag / white wall: at every threshold the egg merges with the background, so no egg-shaped blob exists). Cost: instance F1 down, because on hard images the looser pass also returns non-egg blobs. Sweep T11_fallback_min_score: 0.65 has the best IoU; 0.72 gives better instance F1 but loses IoU.

T11b Fallback pass returns at most 1 egg discarded

- **Why:** T11 removed 9 of 11 empty masks but its looser score also picked wrong blobs (precision and instance F1 down). An image that needs the fallback is a hard image; taking only its single best egg should keep the gain without the extra false eggs.
- **Params:** on top of T11 → `candidate: {"fallback_max_eggs": 1}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.579 (median 0.660), boundary F1 0.456, instance F1 0.603, empty masks 2
- **Decision:** Instance F1 recovers most of what T11 lost, but IoU falls. Only 4 dev images change, all with 1 GT egg: on these hard images the best-scoring fallback blob is often not the egg (#118: the egg was one of T11's 3 blobs, the cap kept a background one). The score can't rank egg vs background here, so capping doesn't help. IoU first -> T11 stays final.

Things that didn't work (summary)

- **Global colour normalisation** (gray-world, CLAHE) — T2
- **Shape filtering after a single threshold** — T7: correct idea, wrong place. Moved into the threshold search (T7b)
- **Ellipse replacement** of the final mask — T9 (and the min-fit sweep: only harmless when it almost never fires)
- **Capping the fallback to 1 egg** — T11b: fewer false eggs, but on those hard images the best-scoring blob is often not the egg
- Bugs found on the way, each from looking at worst-case panels: GrabCut not repeatable (no RNG seed), GrabCut adding far-away background blobs, a degenerate `fitEllipse` result that tried to allocate 71 GB

4. Task 3 — evaluation & analysis

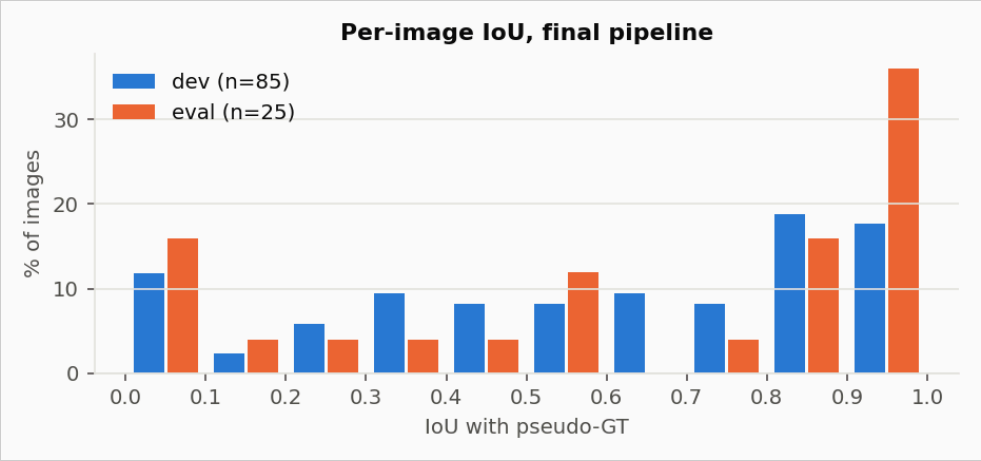
Setup

- GT = Task 1 SAM 2.1 masks, prediction = final pipeline **T11**, frozen before eval was opened
- `final_eval.py` ran dev + eval **once** (2026-10-30T15:17:18); `analyze.py` makes every number and plot below from its saved outputs
- Metrics and why:
  - IoU / Dice — overall overlap, the "match Task 1 quality" number. Per image, then averaged (an empty prediction counts as 0)
  - Pixel precision / recall — tells over- vs under-segmentation apart
  - Boundary F1 at 2 px — edge quality; IoU is forgiving on big eggs
  - Instance precision / recall / F1 (match at IoU ≥ 0.5) and exact egg count — what Task 4 tracking needs

Quantitative results

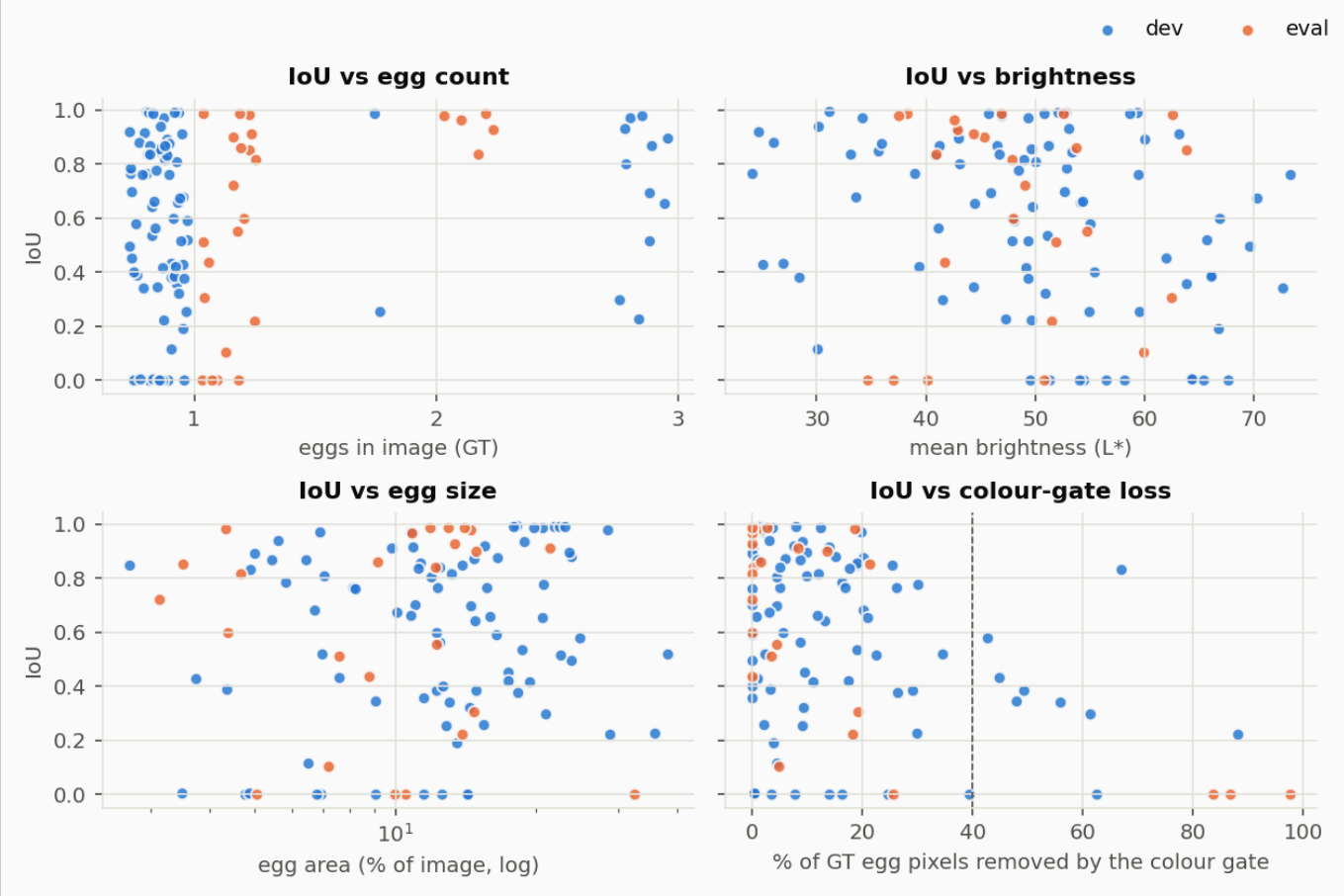
Metric (per-image mean unless noted)	dev (n=85)	eval (n=25)
IoU	0.589	0.618
IoU — median	0.660	0.817
Dice	0.680	0.683
Pixel precision	0.833	0.824
Pixel precision — median	0.990	0.994
Pixel recall	0.639	0.683
Boundary F1 (2 px)	0.458	0.489
Instance precision (IoU ≥ 0.5, pooled)	0.490	0.742
Instance recall (IoU ≥ 0.5, pooled)	0.679	0.767
Instance F1	0.569	0.754
Egg count exactly right (share of images)	0.671	0.800
Images with an empty prediction	2	2
Seconds per image (CPU)	1.52	1.38

- **Eval is a bit higher than dev** (IoU 0.618 vs 0.589). Not tuning luck — scene mix: the hardest backgrounds (white bag, ash, fridge tray, all IoU ≤ 0.34) are only in dev; eval's biggest scene is the steel pot (10 images, IoU 0.83)
- **All-or-nothing**: mean ≪ median. Eval: 13 / 25 images at IoU ≥ 0.8, 4 at exactly 0. Dev: 31 / 85 and 8. When the method finds the egg it's usually good; the mean is dragged down by misses
- **Under-segmentation, not false background**: pixel precision median 0.99 (eval), recall mean only 0.68 → what's predicted is almost always egg, but part of the egg is missing
- **Edges**: boundary F1 0.49 — even good masks are often more than 2 px off SAM's edge, mostly on the shaded rim
- **Instances**: eval instance F1 0.75, dev only 0.57 — dev has keyboards, ash and white bags where extra blobs pass as eggs (instance precision 0.49; e.g. dev #18: 8 predicted eggs for 1 real). Egg count exactly right: 80% of eval images



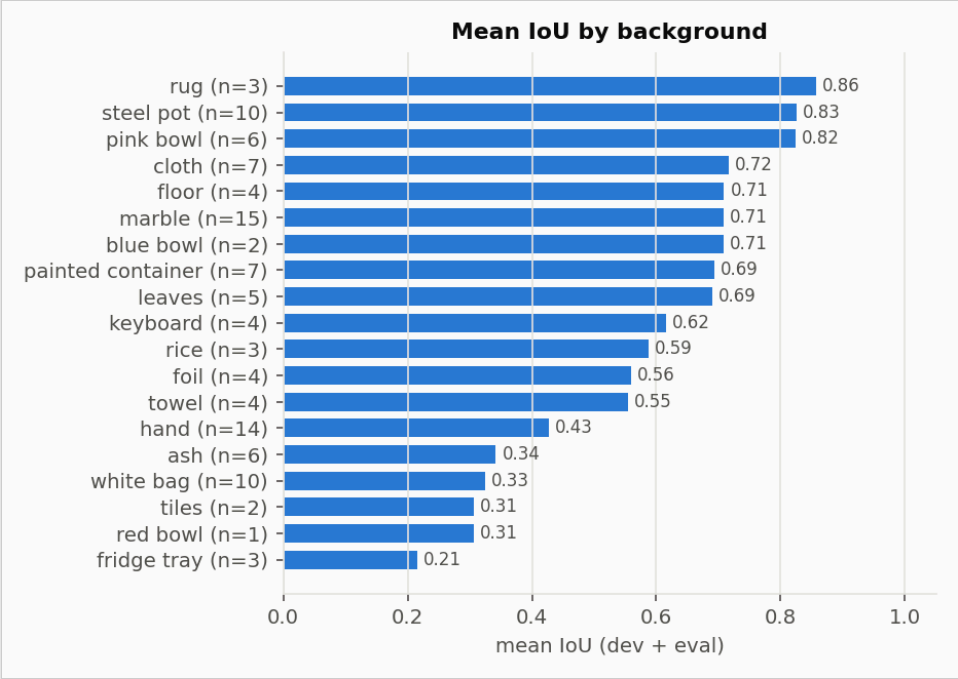
Per-image IoU, dev vs eval (share of images per 0.1 bin).

What the error depends on



Per-image IoU against number of eggs, image brightness and egg size. Spearman ρ (dev + eval): brightness -0.264, egg area 0.128.

- **Colour-gate loss is the strongest factor** (ρ = -0.336): in 12 images the skin / saturation gate throws away ≥ 40% of the egg before thresholding → mean IoU 0.29 vs 0.63 for the rest. Almost all of it is the **skin box**, not saturation (`diagnostics.csv`)
- **Hand in the image**: mean IoU 0.43 vs 0.62. On eval all 3 hand images score 0 — the dark-room / backlit shots
- **Brightness, egg size**: weak (ρ = -0.264 and 0.128). Bright images are often white backgrounds, hence the slight negative trend
- **Egg count**: multi-egg images do better (2 eggs 0.85, 3 eggs 0.71, 1 egg 0.56) — they were shot on high-contrast surfaces (steel pot, marble), so this is a scene effect, not a count effect



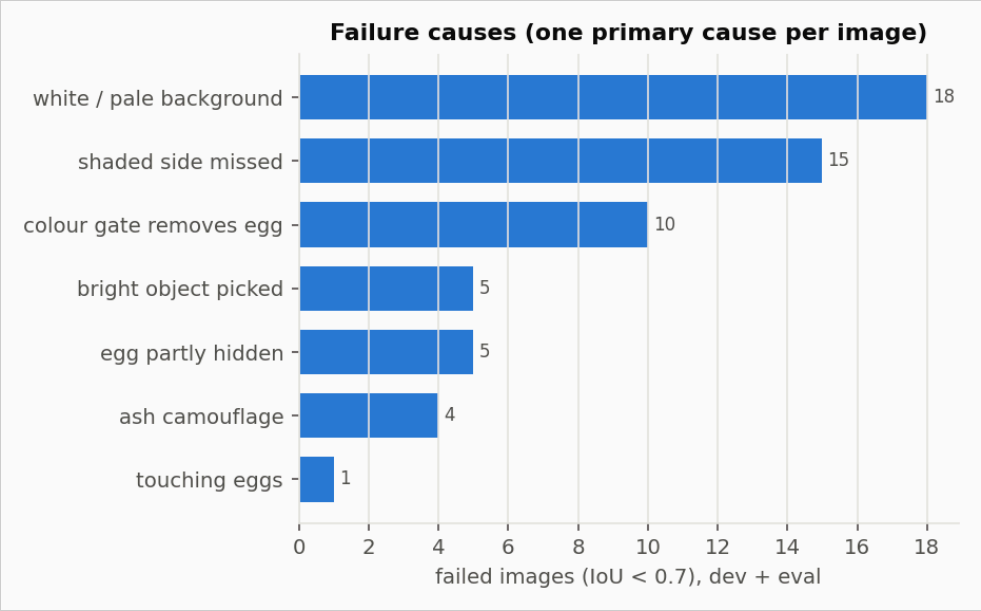
Mean IoU by background type (my manual labels in `data/processed/attributes_manual.csv`, dev + eval).

- Works: coloured or dark backgrounds — rug, steel pot, pink bowl (IoU ≥ 0.82)
- Fails: backgrounds as bright and colourless as the egg — fridge tray 0.21, white bag 0.33, pale tiles 0.31 — and ash 0.34 (egg dusted with the same grey). Red bowl is a single image
- That's the core assumption of the method breaking: "egg = brightest, least-coloured, egg-shaped thing"

Failure taxonomy

- Failure = IoU < 0.7 → 58 images (dev + eval)
- I looked at every one (sheets in `results/analysis/failures/`) and gave each **one primary cause** → `failure_labels.csv`

Primary cause	dev	eval	total
white / pale background	15	3	18
shaded side missed	12	3	15
colour gate removes egg	7	3	10
egg partly hidden	4	1	5
bright object picked	4	1	5
ash camouflage	4	0	4
touching eggs	1	0	1



Primary cause of each failed image.

- How labelled: (1) if most of the error is missed egg (FN > FP) and the colour gate removed ≥ 40% of the egg → "colour gate removes egg"; (2) otherwise by eye from the failure sheet. Notes per image in `failure_labels.csv`
- **White / pale background** (18) — no threshold separates egg from bag / tray / wall; the blob that comes out isn't egg-shaped → egg missed, or the bag picked instead
- **Shaded side missed** (15) — search keeps the lit half; the shaded half is darker than the surface next to it, and GrabCut only partly recovers it
- **Colour gate removes egg** (10) — the Chai & Ngan skin box also matches cream eggs, eggs under warm light, and backlit eggs. All 3 eval misses in the dark-room scene are this (84–98% of the egg removed)
- **Bright object picked** (5) — keyboard keys, foil, polished steel: bright, colourless and convex enough to pass the egg score
- **Egg partly hidden** (5) — leaves, tray bars, boiling water: the visible part isn't egg-shaped
- **Ash camouflage** (4) — egg dusted with ash, lying on ash: same grey, same texture; either nothing egg-shaped is found or the ash patch is taken with the egg
- **Touching eggs** (1) — the merged blob of 3 touching eggs fails the shape score before watershed ever sees it
- **Bad GT**: 0 — no failure was caused by a wrong SAM mask (the known GT error, #17, is not among the failures)

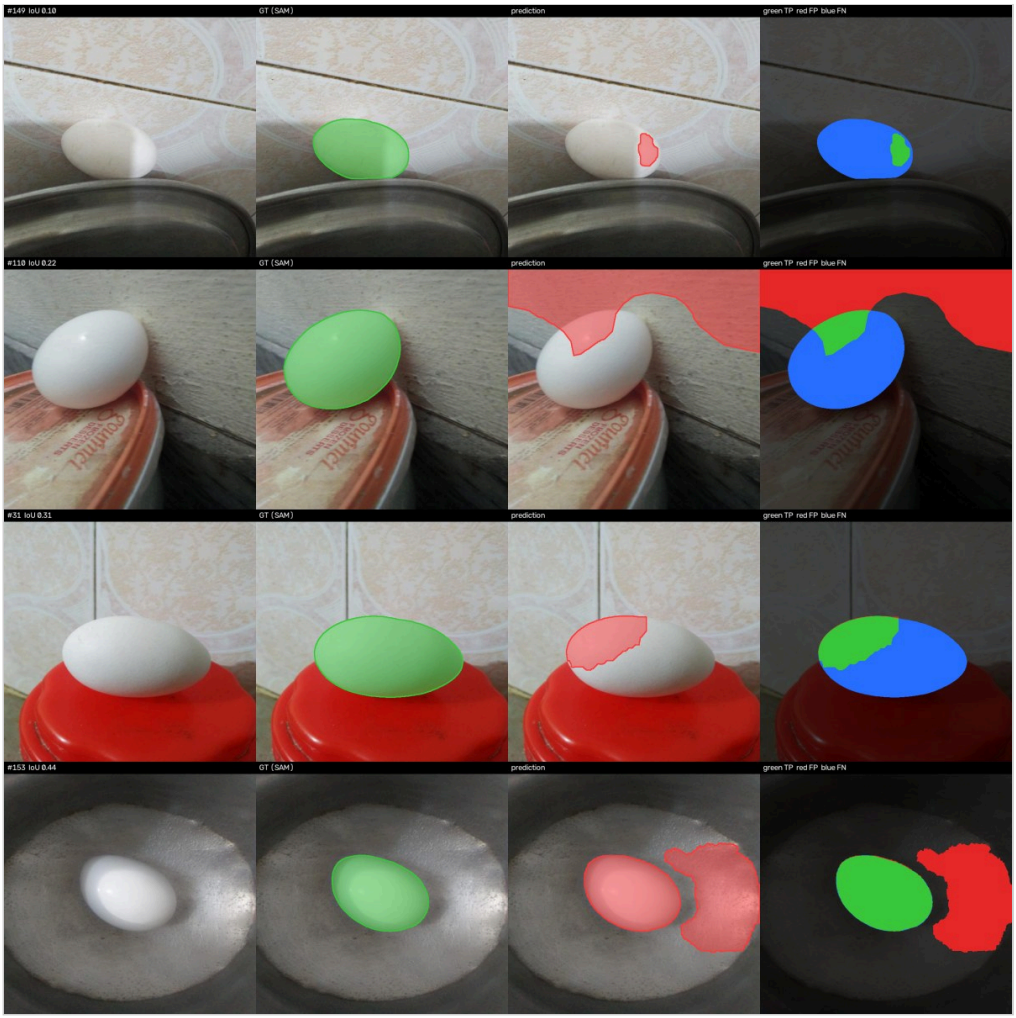
Worst eval images

- Columns: image · GT (SAM) · prediction · error map (**green** = correct egg, **red** = false egg, **blue** = missed egg)



Eval worst 1–4, rows top → bottom: #20, #24, #44, #139.

- **#20, #24, #44** — one scene: egg held up against a lamp / bright wall in a dark room. Backlit, the egg looks orange-brown → the skin box removes 84–98% of it → nothing egg-like is left (#44 keeps two finger blobs, #24 a wall switch, #20 nothing)
- **#139** — white egg against a pale wall: egg and wall merge at every threshold, so no blob is egg-shaped, even at the fallback score



Eval worst 5–8, rows top → bottom: #149, #110, #31, #153.

- **#149** — same as #139 with pale tiles: only a small highlight on the egg is kept
- **#110** — pale wall again; this time the wall itself is taken (big red area) together with a corner of the egg
- **#31** — lit top half found; the shaded lower half is not recovered by GrabCut
- **#153** — egg itself is right; a bright patch of steel / water next to it passes as a second egg

Ablation — what each stage still adds (dev, after the eval run)

- Final pipeline with one stage switched off at a time, **dev only** (`ablation.py`). Several stages were accepted early, on top of a much simpler method — do they still help?
- Run after the eval run, as part of this analysis → nothing here changes the reported pipeline or its eval numbers

Dev, one stage off	IoU mean	Δ IoU	Prec.	Recall	Bnd F1	Inst F1	Empty
final pipeline	0.589		0.833	0.639	0.458	0.569	2
no skin filter	0.609	+0.020	0.835	0.657	0.477	0.573	2
no saturation filter	0.587	-0.001	0.815	0.643	0.457	0.548	2
no morphology	0.580	-0.009	0.836	0.628	0.448	0.564	2
no GrabCut	0.483	-0.105	0.841	0.514	0.266	0.467	2
no fallback pass	0.566	-0.023	0.894	0.605	0.445	0.618	11
no watershed	0.589	+0.000	0.833	0.639	0.458	0.564	2

- **GrabCut** is the most important stage: without it IoU 0.483, boundary F1 0.266
- **Fallback pass**: removing it gives back exactly T10 (11 empty masks) → the IoU / instance-F1 trade-off from the log
- **Watershed**: same IoU by design, instance F1 0.564 → 0.569. Only 5 images have touching eggs
- **The skin filter now hurts**: without it dev IoU goes 0.589 → 0.609. It helped in T3, when the candidate was one Otsu threshold that grabbed whole hands. The shape search ignores hands anyway (not egg-shaped), so the skin box now mostly deletes warm-lit egg pixels — the same thing the colour-gate diagnostic and the failure taxonomy show. Lesson: re-check early decisions once the pipeline around them changes
- I did **not** switch it off in the final pipeline: that would be a change made after seeing eval results, and the eval run would no longer be a clean test. It's the first item below

Performance gaps → what I'd improve

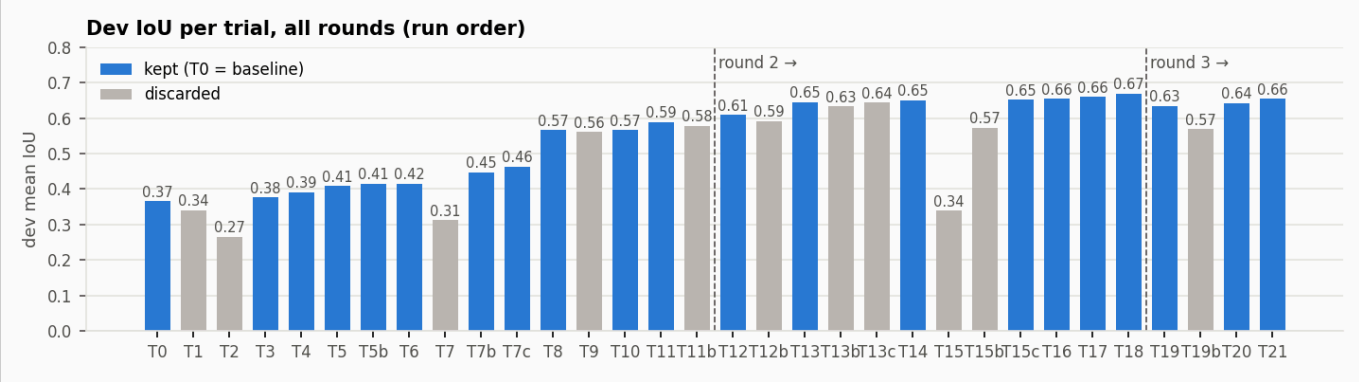
1. **Colour gate** (10 failures + part of "shaded side"). Drop the skin box, or only remove skin regions that are large and touch the image border (hands come in from the edge). Dropping it alone: dev IoU 0.589 → 0.609 (ablation above)
2. **White / pale backgrounds** (18, the biggest group). Brightness and colour carry no signal there → use edges and shading: an egg is a smooth closed outline with a soft shading gradient and a cast shadow. E.g. ellipse detection on edges (Hough / RANSAC on Canny), or a gradient term in the egg score
3. **Shaded side missed** (15). The search finds the lit cap; give GrabCut the cap's fitted ellipse (slightly enlarged) as "probably egg". T9 forced the ellipse as the final mask, which was too strong; as a GrabCut seed the colour model still decides
4. **False eggs** on keys, foil, steel (5) and from the fallback pass. Add a check for straight edges / corners and high-frequency texture — eggs have neither
5. **Touching eggs**: split merged blobs with watershed *before* the shape score, so 2–3 touching eggs aren't rejected as one non-egg blob
6. **Evaluation itself**: GT is SAM pseudo-GT, so boundary F1 at 2 px also counts SAM's edge error; a few hand-drawn masks would show how much of the gap is the GT. Eval has only 5 scenes → per-scene numbers say more than the mean

- → All five were tried in round 2 (§5), each as its own dev trial
- Bottom line: the method does well when the egg is the brightest, least-coloured, egg-shaped thing in view (IoU ≥ 0.8 on 13 / 25 eval images), and fails completely when that's not true. Closing the rest of the gap to SAM needs cues beyond brightness — edges, shading, context

5. Round 2 — improving the method after the analysis

Why a second round, and the rules

- Round 1 (§3–4) is kept exactly as it was — trials T0–T11b, the one clean eval run of T11 (IoU 0.618), the failure taxonomy
- Round 2 = the five improvements listed at the end of §4, each tried as its own trial (T12 onwards) on **dev only**, same decision rule as round 1
- The ideas came from looking at round-1 failures, eval images included → the round-2 eval number is a **second look at eval**, not a clean test. Reported separately, never replaces the round-1 number
- Code: every new option defaults to off, and T11 was re-run after the changes: 85 / 85 dev images give the same IoU → round 1 still reproduces



Dev mean IoU of every trial, both rounds. Grey = discarded.

Round-2 experiment log (dev, 85 images)

Trial	Change	IoU mean	IoU med.	Prec.	Recall	Bnd F1	Inst F1	Empty	Decision
T12	skin filter off	0.609	0.667	0.835	0.657	0.477	0.573	2	kept
T12b	skin filter only removes large skin regions that touch the image border	0.592	0.660	0.835	0.642	0.462	0.571	2	discarded
T13	GrabCut also gets each egg's fitted ellipse (x1.15) as 'probably egg'	0.646	0.717	0.807	0.721	0.517	0.615	2	kept
T13b	Local Otsu growth around each found egg before GrabCut	0.633	0.727	0.823	0.691	0.493	0.588	2	discarded
T13c	T13 + local Otsu growth (both shaded-side fixes together)	0.645	0.716	0.788	0.738	0.502	0.626	2	discarded
T14	Split non-egg-shaped blobs with watershed inside the search and score each piece	0.650	0.717	0.804	0.740	0.524	0.617	2	kept
T15	Egg score also rewards blob outlines that lie on Canny edges (weight 0.5)	0.339	0.000	0.685	0.379	0.306	0.406	33	discarded
T15b	Add ellipses fitted to Canny edge chains as extra egg candidates	0.573	0.647	0.705	0.728	0.462	0.477	2	discarded
T15c	Edge support only ranks candidates; the 0.80 cut stays on the plain shape score	0.652	0.727	0.801	0.737	0.523	0.608	2	kept
T16	Reject rectangular blobs (area / min bounding rect > 0.9) and textured blobs (mean |Laplacian| > 5)	0.655	0.727	0.818	0.720	0.527	0.639	2	kept
T17	All kept round-2 changes together: T13 + T14 + T15c + T16	0.660	0.728	0.802	0.744	0.540	0.647	2	kept
T18	T17 with edge weight 0.3 (from sweep T17_edge_weight)	0.669	0.732	0.811	0.744	0.544	0.658	2	kept

What worked, what didn't

- **1. Skin filter** — off (T12): 0.589 → 0.609. The smarter version (only big skin regions on the border, T12b) lost: warm marble floors are "skin" too and take the egg with them
- **2. Shaded side** — GrabCut gets the egg's fitted ellipse ×1.15 as "probably egg" (T13): 0.609 → 0.646, recall 0.66 → 0.72. Biggest round-2 gain. Local Otsu growth (T13b) helped less; both together (T13c) no better than T13
- **3. Touching eggs** — split merged blobs before scoring (T14): small gain (0.650); the target image #144 is still not fixed
- **4. White backgrounds via edges** — two failures, then a fix:
  - T15: edge support multiplied into the score → 0.339, 33 empty masks. My design mistake: it lowered every score below the 0.80 cut
  - T15b: ellipses fitted to Canny edges as new candidates → 0.573. No change on white bags, fridge trays or rice (the targets); many false eggs on ash and towels
  - T15c: edge support only used to *rank* candidates → 0.652, kept
- **5. False eggs** — reject rectangular (key caps) and textured (foil) blobs, limits taken from the dev GT eggs (T16): 0.655, instance F1 0.615 → 0.639
- **Together** (T17): 0.660 — the changes add up. Edge weight re-tuned by a sweep on T17 → **T18: 0.669**, the final round-2 pipeline
- Sweeps on T17 move IoU by < 0.01 and not monotonically → with 85 dev images that's close to noise; I followed the rule but wouldn't read much into the third decimal

Parameter sweeps (round 2, dev)

Sweep (dev)	On top of	Values → dev IoU mean	Picked
`grabcut.ellipse_prior`	T13	1.05 → 0.637 · 1.15 → 0.646 · 1.3 → 0.636	1.15
`candidate.edge_weight`	T17	0.3 → 0.669 · 0.5 → 0.660 · 0.8 → 0.661	0.3
`candidate.max_texture`	T17	3.5 → 0.666 · 5.0 → 0.660 · 8.0 → 0.664	3.5

Per-trial notes, round 2

T12 skin filter off `kept`

- **Why:** Round-1 analysis: in 12 images the skin box removes >= 40% of the egg (cream eggs, warm light, backlit eggs); those images average IoU 0.29. The skin filter was accepted in T3, when the candidate was one Otsu threshold that grabbed whole hands. The egg-shape search should reject hands on its own.
- **Params:** on top of T11 → `skin: {"enabled": false}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.609 (median 0.667), boundary F1 0.477, instance F1 0.573, empty masks 2
- **Decision:** IoU 0.589 -> 0.609. The shape search already rejects hands (not egg-shaped), so the skin box mostly removed warm-lit egg pixels: #100 0.22 -> 0.90, #140 0.30 -> 0.91 (same trend as the round-1 ablation).

T12b skin filter only removes large skin regions that touch the image border `discarded`

- **Why:** Keep what the skin filter is for (hands come into the photo from the edge) without deleting egg-sized warm/cream regions in the middle of the image.
- **Params:** on top of T11 → `skin: {"mode": "border_regions", "min_region": 0.02, "close": 7}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.592 (median 0.660), boundary F1 0.462, instance F1 0.571, empty masks 2
- **Decision:** Better than T11 but well below T12. On warm marble floors the floor itself is in the skin box and forms one big region touching the border, which takes the egg's warm side with it (#100: 0.22 vs 0.90 with T12, #140: 0.30 vs 0.91). Only 2 images are > 0.05 better than T12.

T13 GrabCut also gets each egg's fitted ellipse (x1.15) as 'probably egg' `kept`

- **Why:** 15 round-1 failures are 'shaded side missed': the search keeps the lit cap and GrabCut only partly grows it. Marking the enlarged ellipse as probable egg puts the shaded side into the egg colour model from the start.
- **Params:** on top of T12 → `grabcut: {"ellipse_prior": 1.15}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.646 (median 0.717), boundary F1 0.517, instance F1 0.615, empty masks 2
- **Decision:** Recall 0.657 -> 0.721 and boundary F1 up: the shaded side now gets into GrabCut's egg colour model. Precision drops a little (the ellipse is slightly larger than some eggs). Beats the T13b alternative.

T13b Local Otsu growth around each found egg before GrabCut `discarded`

- **Why:** Same failure as T13, different fix: the threshold that isolates the egg globally is too high for its shaded side. Re-threshold locally (Otsu inside the egg's ellipse x1.4) and add connected pixels inside the ellipse x1.15.
- **Params:** on top of T12 → `grow: {"enabled": true, "roi_scale": 1.4, "keep_scale": 1.15}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.633 (median 0.727), boundary F1 0.493, instance F1 0.588, empty masks 2
- **Decision:** Helps (T12 0.609 -> 0.633) but less than T13 (0.646), with lower boundary F1 and instance F1: a local Otsu threshold still cuts the shaded side wherever it is darker than the surface beside it, while GrabCut's colour model can include it.

T13c T13 + local Otsu growth (both shaded-side fixes together) `discarded`

- **Why:** T13 and T13b attack the same failure differently; check whether they add up.
- **Params:** on top of T13 → `grow: {"enabled": true, "roi_scale": 1.4, "keep_scale": 1.15}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.645 (median 0.716), boundary F1 0.502, instance F1 0.626, empty masks 2
- **Decision:** No gain over T13 alone (IoU 0.645 vs 0.646, boundary F1 lower). Once GrabCut has the ellipse prior, the extra pixels from local growth are mostly ones GrabCut already adds, plus some background (precision down).

T14 Split non-egg-shaped blobs with watershed inside the search and score each piece kept

- **Why:** Touching eggs merge into one blob that fails the egg-shape score and is thrown away before the watershed stage ever sees it (round-1 #144: 2 of 3 eggs missed).
- **Params:** on top of T13 → `candidate: {"split_merged": true, "split_peak_rel": 0.6, "split_min_core_px": 30}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.650 (median 0.717), boundary F1 0.524, instance F1 0.617, empty masks 2
- **Decision:** Small IoU gain (0.646 -> 0.650) and recall up. Its target #144 is unchanged (0.27); the gain comes from other touching eggs, e.g. #136 now has 2 of 3 eggs matched instead of 1. Also #111 0.35 -> 0.98 (single egg on a pale surface, probably joined to it at the threshold where the whole egg shows up).

T15 Egg score also rewards blob outlines that lie on Canny edges (weight 0.5) discarded

- **Why:** 18 round-1 failures are white / pale backgrounds: a threshold cut through a flat white bag has no image edge under it, a real egg outline does. Weighting the score by edge support should prefer real eggs over bag patches.
- **Params:** on top of T13 → `candidate: {"edge_weight": 0.5, "edge_tol": 2, "canny": [30, 90]}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.339 (median 0.000), boundary F1 0.306, instance F1 0.406, empty masks 33
- **Decision:** Failed: IoU 0.339 and 33 empty masks. Design flaw, not a bad idea: multiplying the score by (0.5 + 0.5 * edge support) lowers every score, so most real eggs fell below the 0.80 cut that was tuned for the plain score. Fixed in T15c (edge support only ranks).

T15b Add ellipses fitted to Canny edge chains as extra egg candidates discarded

- **Why:** On a white background no threshold separates the egg at all, so the search has nothing to score. The outline is still an edge: fit ellipses to edge chains, keep those with >= 60% of the perimeter on edges.
- **Params:** on top of T13 → `candidate: {"edge_candidates": true, "edge_min_support": 0.6, "edge_min_pts": 40, "canny": [30, 90]}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.573 (median 0.647), boundary F1 0.462, instance F1 0.477, empty masks 2
- **Decision:** Failed: IoU 0.646 -> 0.573. On its targets it changed nothing (white bag 0.36 -> 0.36, fridge tray and rice unchanged). Instead textured backgrounds produced many edge-chain ellipses: ash 0.38 -> 0.15 (predicted eggs 15 -> 29), towel 0.65 -> 0.36.

T15c Edge support only ranks candidates; the 0.80 cut stays on the plain shape score kept

- **Why:** T15's idea (prefer blobs whose outline lies on image edges, not threshold cuts through a white bag) without its flaw (weighted scores fell below the cut).
- **Params:** on top of T13 → `candidate: {"edge_weight": 0.5, "edge_rank_only": true, "edge_tol": 2, "canny": [30, 90]}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.652 (median 0.727), boundary F1 0.523, instance F1 0.608, empty masks 2
- **Decision:** IoU 0.646 -> 0.652, boundary F1 up: among candidates that already pass the shape cut, the one whose outline sits on real edges wins, instead of a threshold cut through a white background. Instance F1 slightly down (0.615 -> 0.608).

T16 Reject rectangular blobs (area / min bounding rect > 0.9) and textured blobs (mean |Laplacian| > 5) kept

- **Why:** Round-1 false eggs on keyboard keys, foil and steel. Measured on the dev GT eggs: 99% have rectangularity <= 0.83 (an ellipse is 0.785) and texture <= 4.6, so both limits keep real eggs.
- **Params:** on top of T13 → `components: {"max_rectangularity": 0.9}`, `candidate: {"max_texture": 5.0}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.655 (median 0.727), boundary F1 0.527, instance F1 0.639, empty masks 2
- **Decision:** IoU 0.646 -> 0.655 and instance F1 0.615 -> 0.639: key caps, foil and other rectangular or crinkled blobs no longer pass as eggs, and the limits (from the dev GT eggs) don't touch real eggs.

T17 All kept round-2 changes together: T13 + T14 + T15c + T16 kept

- **Why:** T14, T15c and T16 were each tested alone on top of T13. Check that they add up when combined.
- **Params:** on top of T16 → `candidate: {"split_merged": true, "split_peak_rel": 0.6, "split_min_core_px": 30, "edge_weight": 0.5, "edge_rank_only": true, "edge_tol": 2, "canny": [30, 90]}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.660 (median 0.728), boundary F1 0.540, instance F1 0.647, empty masks 2
- **Decision:** The changes add up: IoU 0.660 (best), boundary F1 0.540, instance F1 0.647, all above each single change. Base for the round-2 sweeps; the final round-2 pipeline is T18.

T18 T17 with edge weight 0.3 (from sweep T17_edge_weight) kept

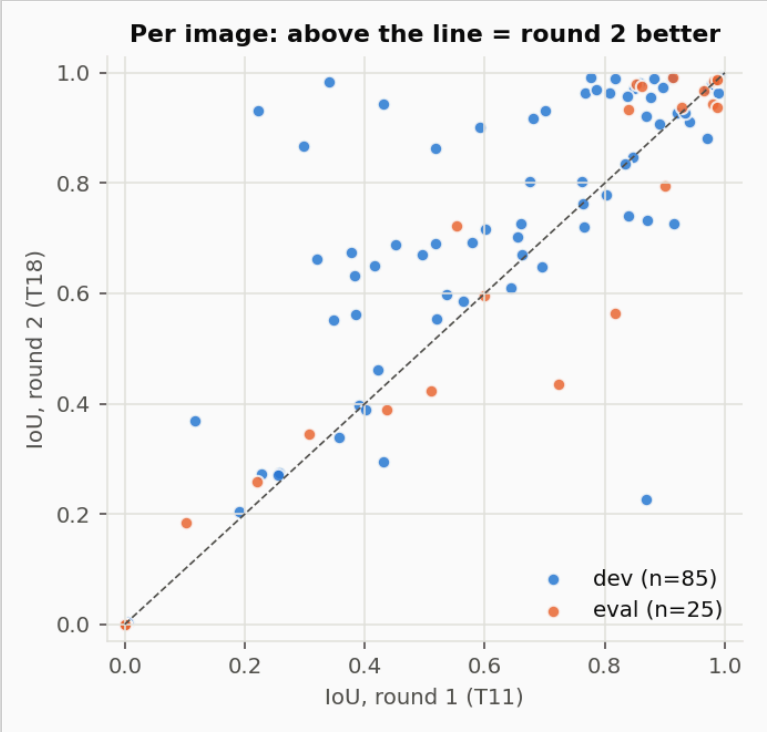
- **Why:** Sweep on T17: edge weight 0.3 gave the best dev IoU and instance F1. Texture limit stays 5.0: 3.5 scored about the same but started rejecting real eggs (one more empty mask), and 5.0 is the limit backed by the dev GT measurement.
- **Params:** on top of T17 → `candidate: {"edge_weight": 0.3}`
- **Dev:** IoU 0.669 (median 0.732), boundary F1 0.544, instance F1 0.658, empty masks 2
- **Decision:** Best dev IoU of both rounds (0.669, median 0.732), instance F1 0.658. Final round-2 pipeline (configs/final_round2.yaml).

Round 2 on eval (second look) vs round 1

- Final round-2 pipeline: **T18** (`configs/final_round2.yaml`), run once on dev + eval by the same `final_eval.py` into its own folder (`results/final_eval_round2/`) — round-1 results untouched

	dev, round 1	dev, round 2	eval, round 1 (clean)	eval, round 2 (2nd look)
IoU mean	0.589	0.669	0.618	0.613
IoU median	0.660	0.732	0.817	0.723
Dice	0.680	0.742	0.683	0.680
Pixel precision	0.833	0.811	0.824	0.767
Pixel recall	0.639	0.744	0.683	0.731
Boundary F1 (2 px)	0.458	0.544	0.489	0.540
Instance F1	0.569	0.658	0.754	0.690
Egg count exactly right	0.67	0.73	0.80	0.92
Images with IoU ≥ 0.8	31	39	13	11
Images with IoU = 0	8	7	4	4
Empty predictions	2	2	2	2

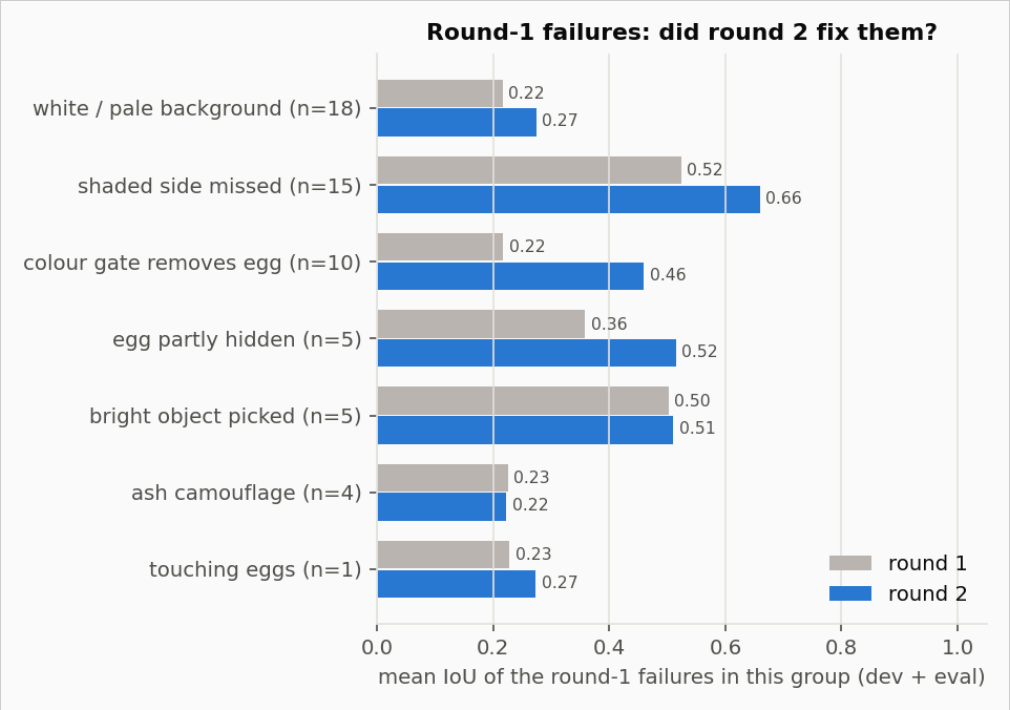
- **Dev**: IoU 0.589 → 0.669; 30 images better by > 0.1, 4 worse
- **Eval: no gain** — 0.618 → 0.613. Recall, boundary F1 and egg count went up; precision, median IoU and instance F1 went down. 3 images better, 3 worse
- Where the change comes from (round-1 failure = IoU < 0.7):
  - dev, the 47 round-1 failures: 0.35 → 0.48 (20 better)
  - eval, the 11 round-1 failures: 0.25 → 0.27 (only 1 better)
  - eval, the 14 images that were already fine: 0.91 → 0.89 (3 worse)
- Reading: round 2 fixed the dev failures it was built from, but not the eval ones. Every eval scene is unseen in dev (that's how the split was made), and the eval failures sit in scenes round 2 has no answer for (backlit hand, pale wall, steel pot — below)
- This is the case for the scene-grouped split: a random split would have put those scenes in dev too and shown a gain
- Eval has 25 images → each one is 4% of the mean; the small drop is within what a single image moves. Honest summary: "no change on eval", not "worse"
- **The headline number stays round 1**: T11, eval IoU 0.618, one clean look



Every image: IoU in round 1 (x) vs round 2 (y). Above the dashed line = better in round 2.

Did round 2 fix the round-1 failures?

Round-1 failure cause	n	IoU round 1	IoU round 2
white / pale background	18	0.22	0.27
shaded side missed	15	0.52	0.66
colour gate removes egg	10	0.22	0.46
egg partly hidden	5	0.36	0.52
bright object picked	5	0.50	0.51
ash camouflage	4	0.23	0.22
touching eggs	1	0.23	0.27

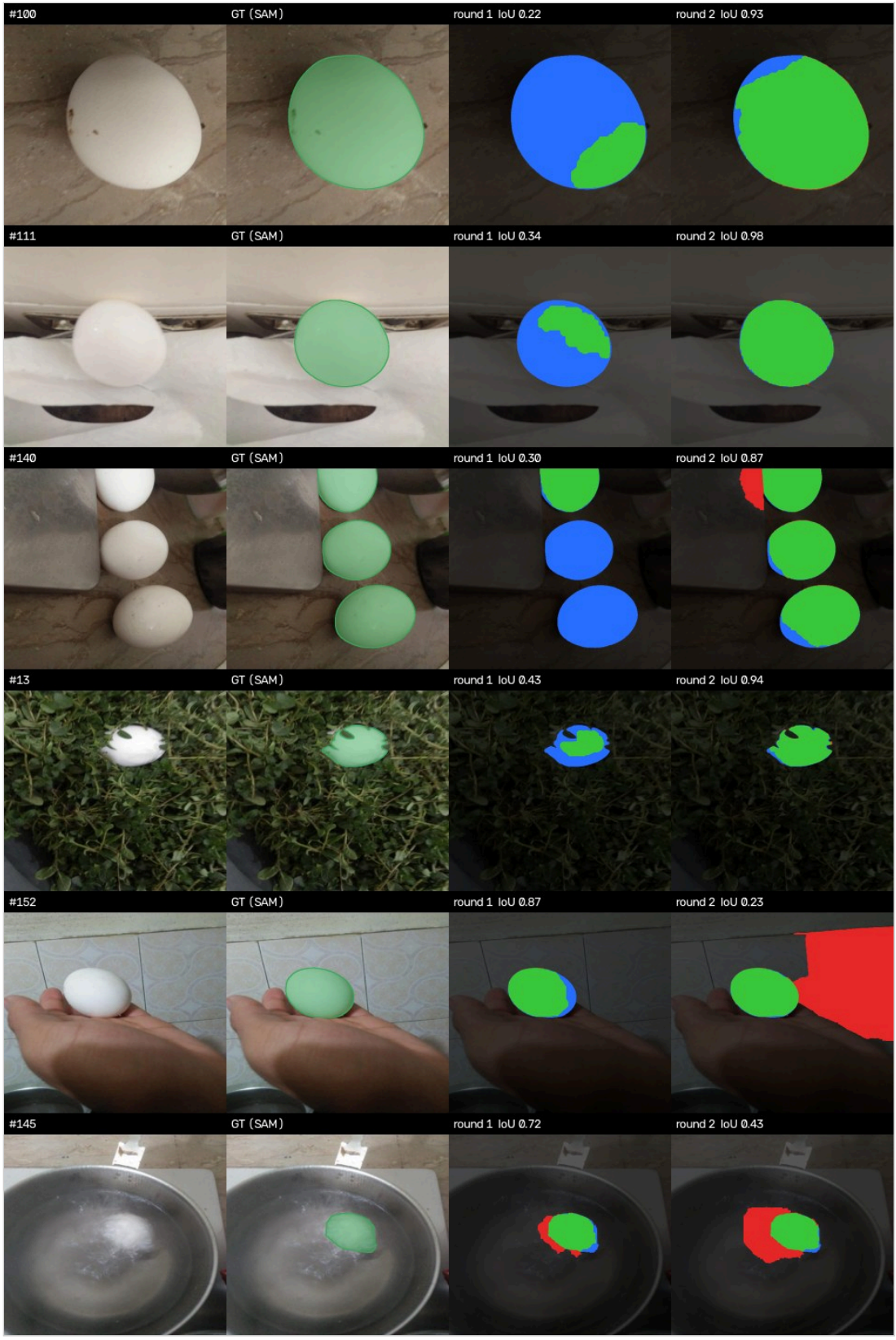


The 58 round-1 failures (IoU < 0.7), grouped by their round-1 cause: mean IoU before and after.

- 12 of 58 round-1 failures are now ≥ 0.7
- Largest gains where round 2 aimed: colour gate 0.22 → 0.46, shaded side 0.52 → 0.66
- White / pale background, the biggest group, barely moved (0.22 → 0.27). Edge ranking (T15c) only re-orders candidates the brightness search already found; the edge-based candidates (T15b) changed nothing on those images
- Ash camouflage and bright objects: no change

Biggest changes

- Columns: image · GT · round-1 error map · round-2 error map (**green** correct, **red** false egg, **blue** missed)



Top 4 rows: largest gains. Last rows: largest losses.

- Gains, traced trial by trial in the dev logs: #100 and #140 from dropping the skin filter (T12), #13 from the ellipse prior (T13), #111 from blob splitting (T14)

Why some images got worse

- Every image that dropped by > 0.1 (7, dev + eval), re-run with one round-2 change undone at a time (`loss_check.py`; analysis only, nothing picked from it). Bold = the undo that helps most

Image	Split	Round 1	Round 2	skin filter back on (T12)	no ellipse prior (T13)	no blob splitting (T14)	no edge ranking (T15c)	no shape/texture reject (T16)
#2	dev	0.91	0.73	0.83	**0.92**	0.73	0.73	0.73
#18	dev	0.43	0.29	0.28	**0.47**	0.29	0.31	0.29
#133	dev	0.87	0.73	0.76	**0.85**	0.73	0.73	0.73
#152	dev	0.87	0.23	0.20	0.22	**0.98**	0.23	0.23
#120	eval	0.90	0.79	**0.96**	0.91	0.79	0.79	0.79
#124	eval	0.82	0.56	0.56	**0.82**	0.56	0.56	0.56
#145	eval	0.72	0.43	0.43	**0.72**	0.43	0.43	0.43

- **Ellipse prior (T13)** is behind 5 of 7: the enlarged ellipse is marked "probably egg", and where the surface next to the egg looks like it, GrabCut keeps it → false egg pixels beside the egg (#145: the water next to it). Same thing as the precision drop in the T13 card
- **Blob splitting (T14)**: #152 — with splitting off it is back to 0.98; most likely a watershed piece of the tile wall passed as an egg. The same change fixed #111 → it helps and hurts on pale backgrounds
- **Skin filter off (T12)**: #120 is the one image where the skin box was doing real work

What is still left

Still IoU 0	Split	Round-1 cause	Egg removed by saturation gate	IoU with that gate off too
#27	dev	ash camouflage	0%	0.00
#30	dev	white / pale background	0%	0.00
#78	dev	ash camouflage	0%	0.00
#116	dev	white / pale background	1%	0.00
#155	dev	white / pale background	4%	0.00
#160	dev	colour gate removes egg	46%	0.00
#161	dev	white / pale background	26%	0.69
#20	eval	colour gate removes egg	76%	0.00
#24	eval	colour gate removes egg	97%	0.00
#44	eval	colour gate removes egg	86%	0.00
#139	eval	white / pale background	20%	0.00

- 7 dev + 4 eval images still at IoU 0. Re-run with the saturation gate off as well: only #161 comes back
- **Backlit hand** (#20, #24, #44 — the eval-only dark-room scene): egg held up against a lamp, the wall behind is brighter than the egg and the egg looks brown. The saturation gate removes most of it, but even without the gate the search finds nothing → a "brightest egg-shaped blob" search can't solve backlit shots
- **Pale backgrounds**: still the biggest group. Needs a cue that isn't brightness or colour (shading gradient, cast shadow) — or a learned model
- **Ellipse prior**: one scale (×1.15) for every egg. Next try: grow it only on the darker side of the egg, or stop GrabCut from keeping "probably egg" pixels that look like the background
- **Method lesson**: a second round designed from looking at failures took dev from 0.589 to 0.669 and eval nowhere. With 85 dev images in 14 scenes, a third round should use cross-validation over scene groups, not one dev / eval cut, to tell real gains from dev-scene fitting

6. Round 3 — trying to stop the overfitting

Why

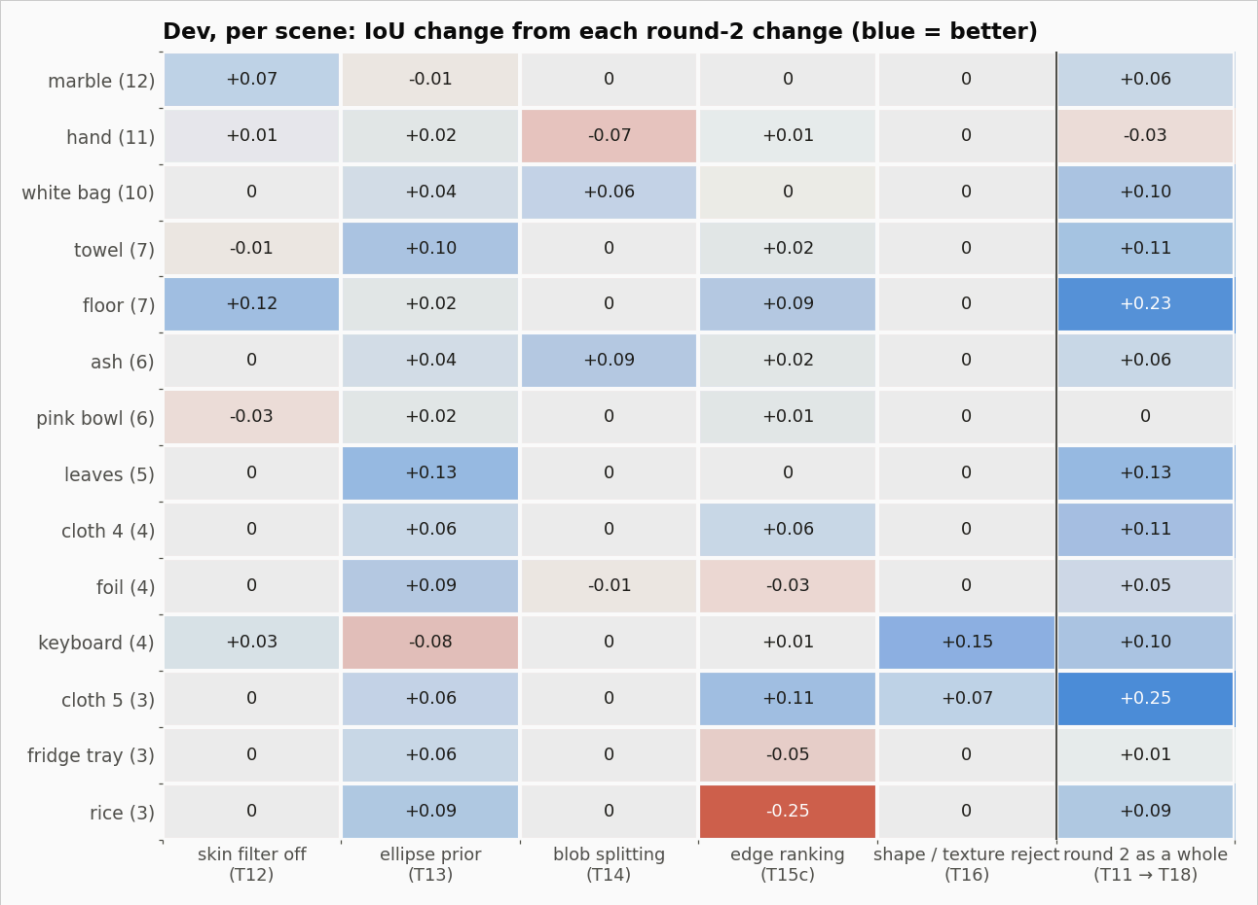
- Round 2: dev 0.589 → 0.669, eval 0.618 → 0.613. The dev gain did not carry over
- Two suspects:
  - too many decisions on the same 85 images (32 trials incl. round 3, 12 sweeps) — the winner of many close comparisons always looks better than it is
  - image mean: a 12-image scene counts 4× a 3-image one, so a change that helps two big scenes looks like a general gain

What changed in the process

- **Decide per scene** (14 dev scenes). Keep a change only if all four hold, against the pipeline without it:
  1. mean scene IoU goes up
  2. more scenes helped than hurt (± 0.01)
  3. no scene loses more than 0.1
  4. scene bootstrap (2000 resamples of the scenes): mean gain > 0 in ≥ 90% of them
- **No sweeps**: every change keeps the value it had before any sweep (e.g. edge weight 0.5, not the swept 0.3)
- **Forward selection** from the round-1 pipeline: try every change, add the passing one with the largest gain, repeat
- **Leave-one-scene-out (LOSO)**: run the whole selection 14 times, each time without one scene, and score the left-out scene with what was chosen. In-sample minus LOSO = how much the selection overfits
- Rule and selection written and committed (`src/eggseg/scenes.py`) before any round-3 run
- To make LOSO cheap: all 48 on/off combinations of the changes run once on dev (`loso.py`); the grid reproduces T11, T12, T13 and T17 image by image

Step 1 — the round-2 decisions, judged per scene

Round-2 change	vs	Δ IoU, image mean (round-2 rule)	Δ IoU, scene mean	Scenes helped / hurt	Worst scene	P(gain), scene bootstrap	Round-3 rule
skin filter off (T12)	T11	+0.020	+0.014	3 / 2	-0.03	0.933	pass
ellipse prior (T13)	T12	+0.037	+0.045	12 / 2	-0.08	0.999	pass
blob splitting (T14)	T13	+0.004	+0.005	2 / 2	-0.07	0.692	fail
edge ranking (T15c)	T13	+0.006	-0.001	6 / 3	-0.25	0.520	fail
shape / texture reject (T16)	T13	+0.010	+0.016	2 / 0	+0.00	0.956	pass
all together (T17)	T13	+0.014	+0.014	8 / 4	-0.25	0.716	fail
edge weight 0.3 (T18)	T17	+0.009	+0.018	1 / 0	-0.00	0.890	fail
round 2 as a whole (T11 → T18)	T11	+0.080	+0.091	11 / 1	-0.03	1.000	pass



Dev, per scene: IoU change from each round-2 change, on the trial it was tested on. Scene = most common background (images).

- 3 of 5 round-2 changes pass. Blob splitting and edge ranking fail
- Edge ranking: small plus on the image mean, but it costs the rice scene 0.25 — exactly the kind of gain round 3 is meant to catch
- Blob splitting: + on ash and white bag, − on the hand scene → a coin flip, not a method
- Ellipse prior: helps 12 of 14 scenes → the most general round-2 change

Step 2 — a safer ellipse prior (failed)

- Idea (from the round-2 losses): stop GrabCut from growing past the fitted ellipse ×1.3. Scale fixed before the run
- T19b: dev IoU 0.569 vs 0.635 without the clip. Loss is all recall: eggs reach well past 1.3× the ellipse fitted to what the search found
- Not re-tuned with a looser value — that would be the same dev fitting again. Logged as a failure

Step 3 — selection on all 14 scenes

Step	Already in	Candidate	Δ scene IoU	Helped / hurt	Worst scene	P(gain)	Rule
1	none (round-1 pipeline)	ellipse prior	+0.051	12 / 1	-0.05	1.000	pass → **added**
1	none (round-1 pipeline)	skin filter off	+0.014	3 / 2	-0.03	0.933	pass
1	none (round-1 pipeline)	shape / texture reject	+0.010	3 / 0	+0.00	0.956	pass
1	none (round-1 pipeline)	blob splitting	+0.007	1 / 2	-0.06	0.612	fail (more helped, bootstrap)
1	none (round-1 pipeline)	edge ranking	+0.002	6 / 3	-0.17	0.592	fail (no scene broken, bootstrap)
1	none (round-1 pipeline)	ellipse prior + clip	-0.020	4 / 8	-0.11	0.059	fail (mean up, more helped, no scene broken, bootstrap)
2	ellipse prior	shape / texture reject	+0.013	2 / 0	+0.00	0.956	pass → **added**
2	ellipse prior	skin filter off	+0.008	2 / 2	-0.02	0.898	fail (more helped, bootstrap)
2	ellipse prior	blob splitting	+0.007	1 / 1	-0.07	0.630	fail (more helped, bootstrap)
2	ellipse prior	edge ranking	-0.004	5 / 3	-0.25	0.469	fail (mean up, no scene broken, bootstrap)
3	ellipse prior + shape / texture reject	skin filter off	+0.011	3 / 2	-0.02	0.954	pass → **added**
3	ellipse prior + shape / texture reject	edge ranking	-0.004	5 / 3	-0.25	0.472	fail (mean up, no scene broken, bootstrap)
3	ellipse prior + shape / texture reject	blob splitting	-0.005	0 / 1	-0.07	0.308	fail (mean up, more helped, bootstrap)
4	ellipse prior + shape / texture reject + skin filter off	blob splitting	-0.000	1 / 1	-0.07	0.458	fail (mean up, more helped, bootstrap)
4	ellipse prior + shape / texture reject + skin filter off	edge ranking	-0.002	6 / 3	-0.25	0.506	fail (mean up, no scene broken, bootstrap)

Trial	Change	IoU mean	IoU med.	Prec.	Recall	Bnd F1	Inst F1	Empty	Decision
T19	Round 3, step 1: ellipse prior on the round-1 pipeline	0.635	0.714	0.811	0.705	0.513	0.602	2	kept
T19b	Round 3, step 1 alternative: ellipse prior + clip (GrabCut may not grow past the fitted ellipse x 1.3)	0.569	0.593	0.825	0.619	0.425	0.549	2	discarded
T20	Round 3, step 2: shape / texture reject on T19	0.643	0.717	0.820	0.705	0.524	0.638	2	kept
T21	Round 3, step 3: skin filter off on T20 - final round-3 pipeline	0.655	0.727	0.818	0.720	0.527	0.639	2	kept

- Result: **T21** = ellipse prior + shape / texture reject + skin filter off. Blob splitting and edge ranking dropped
- Dev IoU 0.655 vs 0.669 for T18 — a bit lower in-sample, with two fewer changes

Step 4 — does the selection overfit? (LOSO)

Selection procedure	Chosen on all 14 dev scenes	Dev IoU, in-sample	Dev IoU, held-out scene (LOSO)	Optimism	Different choices over 14 folds
round-2 rule, round-2 changes	edge ranking + ellipse prior + shape / texture reject + skin filter off	0.661	0.639	+0.023	4
round-3 rule, round-2 changes	ellipse prior + shape / texture reject + skin filter off	0.655	0.615	+0.040	5
round-2 rule, + clip option	edge ranking + ellipse prior + shape / texture reject + skin filter off	0.661	0.639	+0.023	4
round-3 rule, + clip option	ellipse prior + shape / texture reject + skin filter off	0.655	0.615	+0.040	5

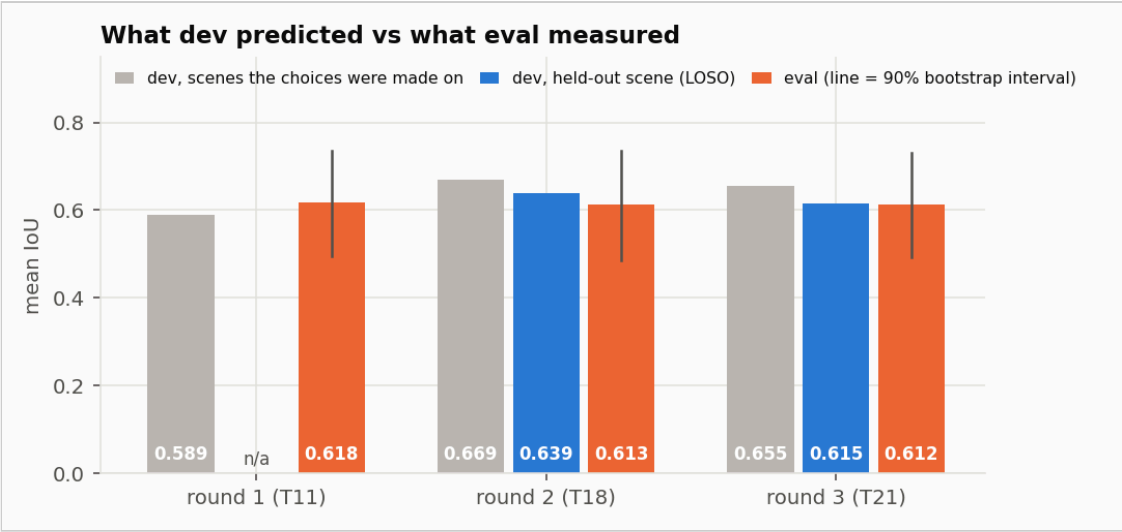
Change: picked in how many of the 14 folds	round-2 rule, round-2 changes	round-3 rule, round-2 changes	round-2 rule, + clip option	round-3 rule, + clip option
skin filter off	14	9	14	9
ellipse prior	14	14	14	14
ellipse prior + clip	–	–	0	0
blob splitting	2	1	2	1
edge ranking	13	1	13	1
shape / texture reject	13	11	13	11

- **Round-2 rule**: in-sample 0.661, held-out scene 0.639 → optimism +0.023. Selection overfitting is real but small. (Round-2 rule re-run on the grid: no sweeps, so it ends at T17 without blob splitting, in-sample 0.661 — not exactly T18)
- **My stricter rule did not reduce it**: optimism +0.040, held-out scene 0.615. With 13 scenes per fold, changes near the threshold flip between pass and fail (skin filter off: picked in 9 of 14 folds) → less stable choices (5 different sets vs 4). A stricter test is not a more stable one
- Stable under both rules: ellipse prior, picked in 14 / 14. Under the scene rule blob splitting is picked in 1 fold, edge ranking in 1 → they fit a few scenes. The clip: 0 folds

Step 5 — eval, third look (after T21 was frozen)

- Run once by the same `final_eval.py` into `results/final_eval_round3/` ; nothing was changed after it

	Dev, in-sample	Dev, held-out scene (LOSO)	Eval	Eval 90% interval	Gap in-sample – eval	Gap held-out – eval
Round 1 (T11)	0.589	–	0.618	0.495 – 0.735	-0.029	–
Round 2 (T18)	0.669	0.639	0.613	0.485 – 0.736	+0.056	+0.025
Round 3 (T21)	0.655	0.615	0.612	0.493 – 0.731	+0.043	+0.003



Round 1 had no scene-level selection to re-run, so no LOSO number.

- Round 3 on eval: 0.612, the same as rounds 1 and 2. Paired with round 1, image by image: -0.006 (90%: -0.042 to +0.027) → no measurable difference
- From round 2 to 3, 0 eval images moved by more than 0.1 → dropping blob splitting and edge ranking cost nothing on eval
- **What changed is the prediction.** Round 2's dev number (0.669) overshot eval by 0.056. Round 3's held-out-scene number (0.615) was off by +0.003
- Eval: 25 images, 5 scenes → the 90% interval is about ±0.12. It can't rank the rounds; the video in §7 is one more unseen scene

What I take from it

- The overfitting here was in the **number**, not a method that falls apart: the in-sample dev IoU promised a gain that unseen scenes don't show. The fix that worked: judge and report on held-out scenes (LOSO), never on the scenes the choices were made on
- Of round 2's 0.056 gap, the selection explains about 0.023 (LOSO). The rest is that eval scenes are different from dev ones → more varied dev scenes or new cues would help; a stricter rule doesn't
- My stricter keep rule was not the fix I expected: with 14 scenes it decides less stably. Worth retrying only with more scenes
- Final pipeline: **T21** — three changes instead of five, same eval, an honest estimate. Used for Task 4, where round 1 does clearly better (§7)

7. Task 4 — video tracking

- **Output videos (Google Drive):** https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/14QTbN2sMEghD2fOjj1JwozyTFmwKRztc
- Five videos, 1280×720, 24 fps: `sam2_tracking.mp4` (reference), `classical_T21_tracking.mp4` (planned pipeline + tracker), `side_by_side_T21.mp4`, and the round-1 versions `classical_T11_tracking.mp4`, `side_by_side_T11.mp4` (run after the fresh test, below)
- Same colour = same egg: each classical id takes the colour of the SAM egg it follows most

The video

- "Raw and Boiled Egg Spinning" (Mocomi, YouTube): 60 s, 24 fps, 1920×1080 → processed at 1280×720
- Egg scene: frames 222–1004 (783 of 1440 frames). Two white eggs on a dark table; a hand spins them, picks them up and covers them; white text labels ("Raw Egg", "Plane surface") over the scene. Title cards before and after, closed by an iris wipe
- A scene none of rounds 1–3 has seen → also used as a fresh test (below)

Reference: SAM 2.1 video tracking

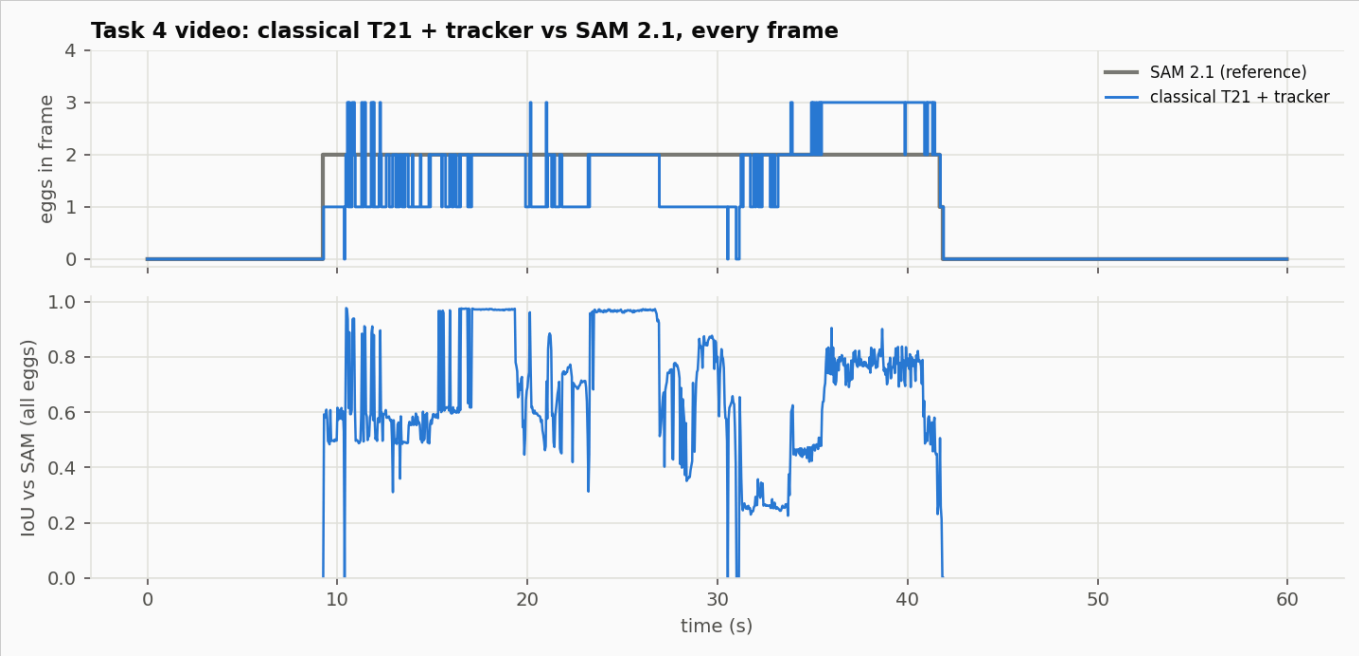
- Same models as Task 1: Grounding DINO ("egg.") → boxes → SAM 2.1 Hiera Base+, but its **video predictor**: a memory of past frames carries each egg's mask forward, so each egg keeps one id
- All 1440 frames don't fit in this laptop's memory → chunks of 48 frames (2 s). The masks on a chunk's last frame are the prompts for the next chunk, so ids carry over. Grounding DINO runs again at every chunk start for new eggs; while nothing is tracked it scans every 6th frame
- Result: 2 ids in the whole video, both eggs, so no id changes and nothing on the title cards or text labels
- SAM is the reference, not the truth (as in Task 1): in fast spins and under the hand its masks can be off too

My tracker, on top of T21

- Per frame: the round-3 pipeline T21 (unchanged — same code and parameters as Tasks 2–3) → egg instances
- Match frame to frame: Hungarian assignment on mask IoU between a track's last mask shifted by its velocity and each new egg. No overlap but close (≤ 1.5 egg diameters + speed × frames missed) → weak match, so a fast-spinning egg is still followed
- A new egg gets an id only after 3 frames in a row → one-frame false eggs never get an id
- A lost egg keeps its id for 2 s (48 frames) → same id when it comes back from under the hand
- No appearance model: the two eggs look the same, so position and motion are all there is

Results vs SAM 2.1

vs SAM 2.1, every frame	T21 + tracker (round 3, planned)	T11 + tracker (round 1, after the fresh test)
Reference eggs (SAM, summed over frames)	1562	1562
Classical eggs (summed over frames)	1413	1356
Recall — SAM eggs matched (IoU ≥ 0.5)	0.535	0.848
Precision — classical eggs that match a SAM egg	0.591	0.976
Mean IoU of matched eggs	0.910	0.940
Mean IoU per frame, all eggs (frames with eggs)	0.671	0.864
Egg count exactly right (frames with eggs)	0.406	0.700
ID switches	8	2
MOTA	0.159	0.826
IDF1	0.216	0.605
Egg ids: SAM / classical	2 / 7	2 / 6
False eggs in frames without eggs	1	1



Every frame: eggs found (top) and IoU vs SAM (bottom). Gaps = frames without eggs in either.

- T21 is the planned pipeline (frozen in round 3, before the video). The T11 column was added after the fresh test below, so it saw the video and is not a clean test. The text here is about T21
- When an egg is matched, its mask is close to SAM's: matched IoU 0.910 → the outline is fine; finding and separating the eggs is not
- Low MOTA (0.159): misses (727) + false eggs (578) out of 1562 reference eggs. Id switches (8) are a tiny part
- Outside the egg scene (title cards, iris wipe): 1 false egg in total

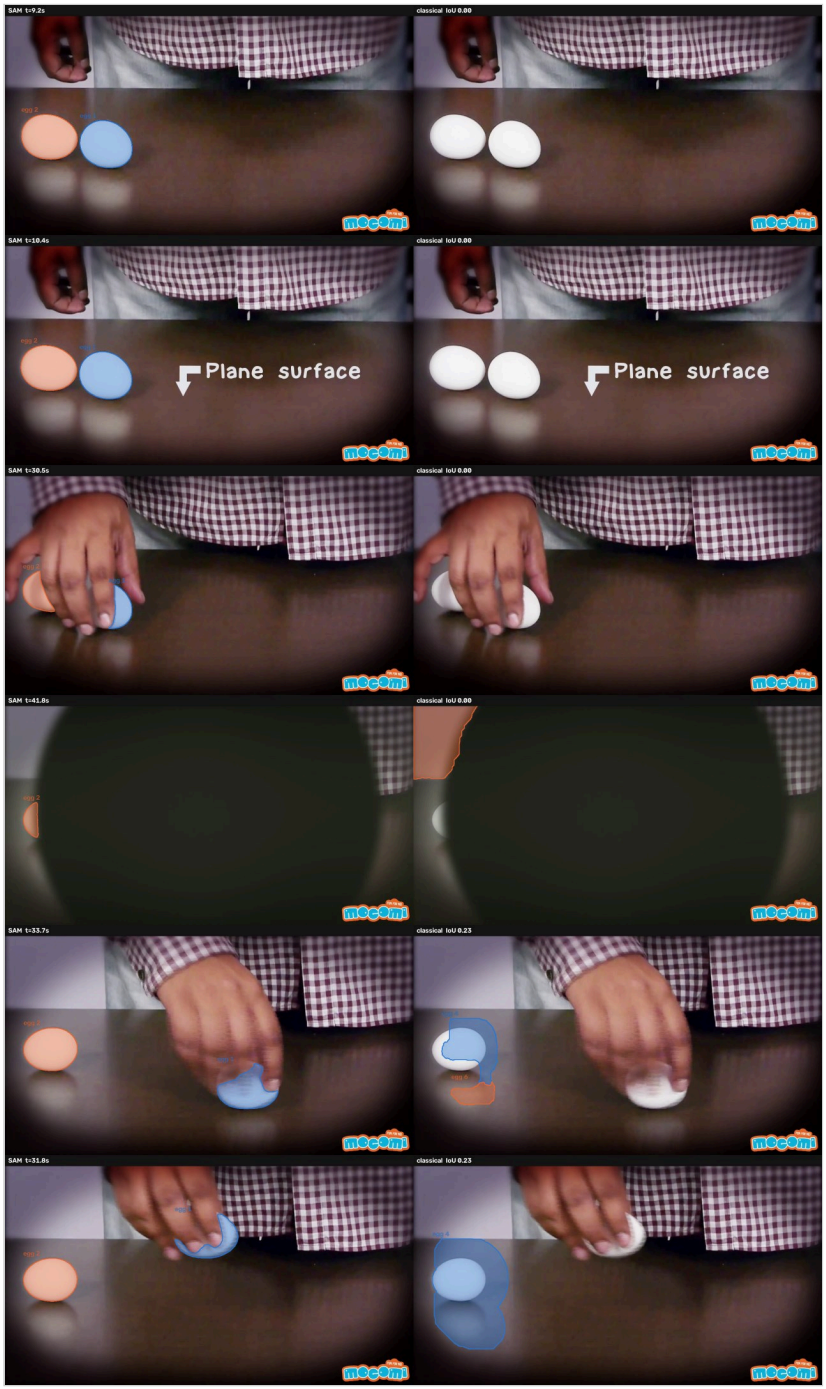
Where the errors come from

- Each missed SAM egg and each false classical egg gets one cause, from the masks (`errors()` in `task4_analyze.py`); checked by eye on frames from each group

Error, one cause each	Count	Share	When (s)
Missed SAM eggs: 727			
merged with the other egg	374	51%	9–17, 19–21, 29–30
mask too big (spills onto table or reflection)	132	18%	12–15, 20, 22, 27–29, 30 …
mask too small (part of the egg)	4	1%	13, 16, 19
mask off target	17	2%	10, 16, 31–34, 41
segmented, but not kept by the tracker	12	2%	20, 23, 28, 30, 34
not segmented	188	26%	9, 10, 20, 21–23, 27–34 …
False classical eggs: 578			
wrong shape of a real egg	374	65%	9–17, 19–21, 22, 27–29, 31–37 …
below an egg (reflection position)	192	33%	10–12, 31–34, 35–42
elsewhere	12	2%	20–22, 23, 42

- **Touching eggs**, 9–17 s (374 misses, 51%): the two eggs touch and stand on their own bright reflections → eggs + reflections become one blob, and watershed doesn't split it. Round 1 separates the same two eggs (fresh test below), so the reflections are the problem more than the touching
- **Reflections**: the table is glossy, and the reflection under an egg is white, egg-sized and roughly egg-shaped → 192 false eggs right below a real egg, and masks that spill onto the reflection (132 misses)
- **Hand + spin**, mostly 27–34 s (188 misses): the egg under the fingers is blurred and half hidden → not segmented at all. SAM keeps it from its memory of earlier frames
- **The tracker** drops only 12 eggs the segmentation had → the low score comes from segmentation, not from matching
- No step of the pipeline handles reflections or motion blur, and none was tuned on this video → a scene shift, as on eval

Worst frames



The six lowest-IoU frames, at least 1 s apart. Left: SAM 2.1, right: classical T21 + tracker. Same colour = same egg.

- 9.2 s, 10.4 s: two touching eggs, nothing shown. The only detection is one blob over both eggs (IoU 0.3 with each). At 9.2 s it is in its 2nd frame, and a new egg needs 3. Around 10.4 s the detection flickers between one merged blob and two separate eggs, frame to frame. The merged blob went to an unconfirmed track, so nothing is drawn
- 30.5 s: a hand covers both eggs. SAM still has both; the classical pipeline finds neither
- 31.8 s, 33.7 s: the egg under the hand is missed; the other egg's mask includes its reflection (and at 33.7 s the reflection is a second egg)
- 41.8 s: iris wipe at the end, a sliver of egg; the classical pipeline marks a bright patch at the top-left edge instead

ID switches

- 7 classical ids for SAM's 2. Two switches traced by hand:
- ~21 s: one blob held the egg in the hand, a strip of light background above it and the other egg. When it split, its id stayed on the wrong egg
- ~33.8 s: the egg under the hand was lost and its track coasted; it then took the other egg, whose mask had spilled into a big blob. My gate scales with the larger of the two sizes, so the oversized blob widened it → a flaw in my tracker. Left as found, not tuned on this video
- The colours in the classical video follow the SAM egg each id matches most → after a switch the colours disagree; that is the switch, not a drawing bug

Fresh test: rounds 1–3 on the video

- None of the three rounds was built with this video in view → a clean test after eval was looked at three times. Segmentation only, no tracker, every 6th egg frame vs SAM

Video frames (every 6th with an egg), no tracker	IoU mean	IoU median	90% interval (2 s blocks)	Frames with IoU < 0.5
Round 1 (T11)	0.868	0.957	0.811 – 0.920	4 / 131
Round 2 (T18)	0.677	0.697	0.613 – 0.740	29 / 131
Round 3 (T21)	0.681	0.697	0.616 – 0.746	28 / 131
Round 3 − round 1, same frames	-0.187		-0.253 – -0.123	
Round 3 − round 2, same frames	+0.004		+0.001 – +0.007	
Round 2 − round 1, same frames	-0.191		-0.262 – -0.128	

- **Round 1 is clearly best on the video**: 0.868 vs 0.681 for round 3, paired -0.187 (90%: -0.253 to -0.123). On eval the three rounds were tied (§6) → the changes made on dev hurt on this new scene
- Still one scene (one table, one light, two eggs) → it says the round-2/3 changes are not safe everywhere. It doesn't say round 1 is better in general

Which round-3 change costs on the video

- Diagnosis after the numbers above were seen. Same frames, round 3's path one change at a time; only reported, nothing chosen from it

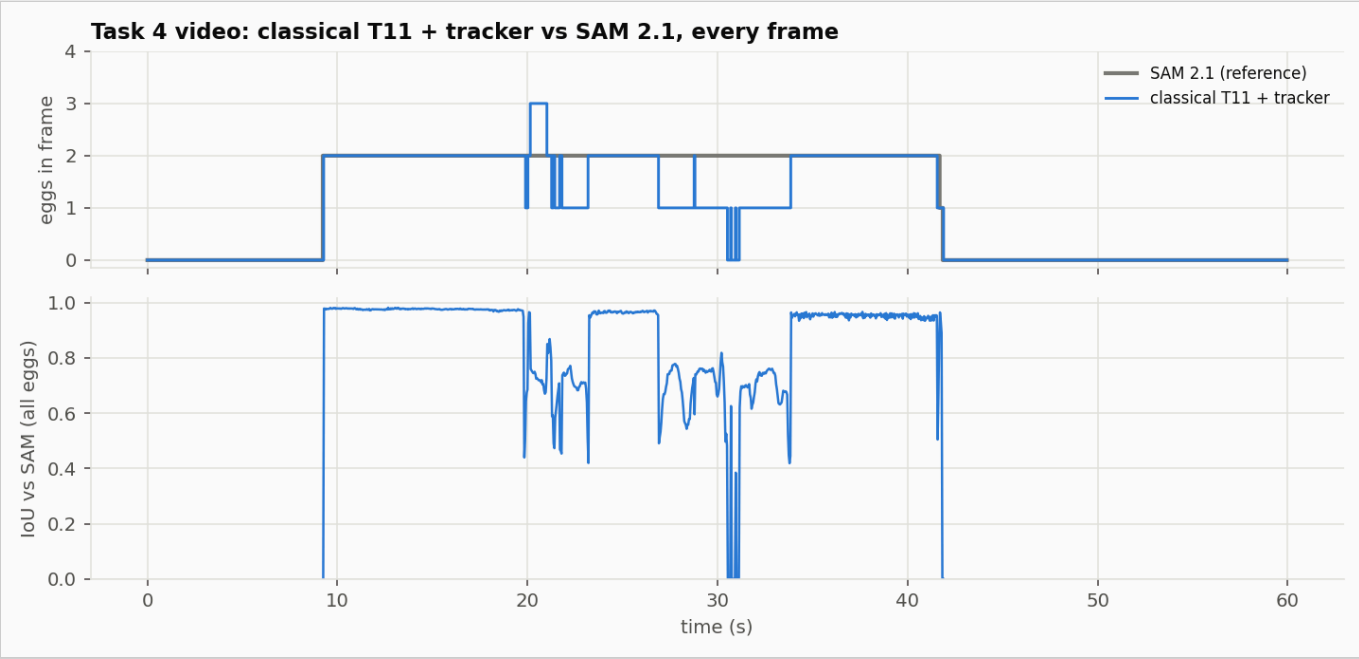
Round 3's path, one change per step	Change	Video IoU	Step Δ	90% interval	Dev scene Δ when kept
T11	round-1 pipeline	0.868	–	–	–
T19	ellipse prior	0.811	-0.057	-0.098 – -0.022	+0.051
T20	shape / texture reject	0.811	+0.000	+0.000 – +0.000	+0.013
T21	skin filter off	0.681	-0.130	-0.192 – -0.070	+0.011

- **Skin filter off** costs the most. In this video the skin colour box (Chai & Ngan, YCbCr) covers 95% of the table just under the eggs (where the reflections are) and 49% of everything else, but only 7% of the eggs (every 6th egg frame)
- So with the filter on, the table and the reflections are taken out before the egg search → the eggs stay apart. Off → egg + reflection + the other egg become one blob (the merges and spills above)
- On the photos the same box ate warm-lit eggs (T12: #100, #140), which is why rounds 2 and 3 turned it off. The scene rule kept that by a thin margin: dev scenes +0.011, 3 helped / 2 hurt, P(gain) 0.95, and one step earlier it had failed (P 0.898)
- **Ellipse prior** costs less, mostly in hand frames (19–21 s, 28–35 s): the egg's mask grows a halo into the dark table beside it

- Lesson: a colour filter can be noise on one set of scenes and essential on another. 14 dev scenes are too few to tell → more varied scenes before trusting any keep / drop (as in §6)

Round 1 + the same tracker (run after the fresh test)

- Not planned: run because the fresh test showed round 1 is better here → it saw the video and is not a clean test. Same tracker, same settings, nothing tuned. Numbers in the second column of the table above
- MOTA 0.159 → **0.826**, IDF1 0.216 → 0.605, precision 0.976: with the eggs segmented apart and no reflections, the same tracker does well
- No merges, spills or reflection eggs left. The 230 "not segmented" misses fall at 19–23 s and 27–34 s (an egg in or under the hand, checked on sample frames) and in the iris wipe. The 32 false eggs are mostly at 19–22 s (at 20.4 s: a strip of light background between the hand and the shirt)
- 2 id switches, both the same kind: an egg under the hand for longer than the 2 s coast (~27–31 s and ~31–34 s) comes back with a new id → IDF1 stays at 0.605. With two identical eggs a longer coast would only be a guess, so I left it



Round 1 (T11) + the same tracker vs SAM 2.1, every frame.

What I'd do next

- Skin box: on for this kind of scene, off for warm-lit eggs on the photos → it needs a rule, not one global switch. One candidate is T12b (skin removed only in big regions touching the border): here the table is one such region. Untested on the video, and it would need new scenes to judge, not this one
- Reflections: a reflection is darker and blurrier than the egg right above it → reject a blob that sits under a brighter egg-shaped blob
- Eggs under the hand: carry the mask forward with optical flow while the egg is covered, instead of dropping it
- Tracker gate: use the track's own size, not the larger of the two, so a spilled blob can't widen it

8. How to run

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
python scripts/download_assets.py          # SAM 2.1 checkpoint (+ dataset if missing)
python scripts/task1_sam2_groundtruth.py   # Task 1  -> ground_truth/
python scripts/make_split.py               # Task 2a -> data/splits/split.csv
```

```
# Task 2b: one trial / a sweep (dev only)
python scripts/run_experiment.py experiments/T11/config.yaml --worst 8
python scripts/sweep.py experiments/T8/config.yaml grabcut.bg_dilate "[25, 45, 70]" --name T8_bg_dilate
python scripts/build_log.py               # -> experiments/LOG.md, log.json, progress.png

# Task 3: the single eval run, then analysis + this report
python scripts/final_eval.py              # trial named in configs/final.yaml
python scripts/analyze.py                 # -> results/analysis/
python scripts/ablation.py                # dev only -> results/ablation/

# Round 2: second, separate eval run of the round-2 pipeline, then the comparison
python scripts/final_eval.py --config configs/final_round2.yaml --out results/final_eval_round2
python scripts/compare_rounds.py          # -> results/round2/ (tables, plots, changes.jpg)
python scripts/loss_check.py              # -> results/round2/loss_check.json

# Round 3: per-scene check, 48-pipeline dev grid + leave-one-scene-out, then the third eval run
python scripts/scene_check.py             # -> results/round3/scene_check.json, .png
python scripts/loso.py                    # -> results/round3/grid_dev.csv, loso.json
python scripts/final_eval.py --config configs/final_round3.yaml --out results/final_eval_round3
python scripts/round3_check.py            # -> results/round3/check.json, predicted_vs_eval.png

# Task 4: the video is not in the repo (download it from YouTube, see README)
python scripts/task4_sam_video.py --video <mp4>   # frames + SAM 2.1 tracks -> data/video/
python scripts/task4_track.py --trial T21  # classical T21 + tracker
python scripts/task4_analyze.py --trial T21  # -> results/task4/ (metrics, plots, the 3 videos)
python scripts/task4_holdout.py           # rounds 1-3 on the video -> results/task4/holdout.json
python scripts/build_report.py            # -> report/report.html + report.pdf
pytest tests/
```

- Tested on Windows 11, Python 3.13, PyTorch 2.6 + CUDA 12.4, RTX 4070 Laptop (8 GB). Task 2/3 need only OpenCV, NumPy, PyYAML, matplotlib (CPU)

9. AI tools

- Claude Code (AI coding assistant) used for: writing the scripts (GT pipeline, split, classical pipeline, experiment runner, evaluation, figures, Task 4 tracker and video export) and drafting this report
- Decisions (what to try next, keep / discard, failure labels) were made by looking at dev results and worst-case panels; every number in this report is filled in by `build_report.py` from saved result files

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